Tahdhīb al-Kalām

تهذيب الكلام

Saʿd al-Dīn al-Taftāzānī · Stage 75 Cairo 1912 working bilingual text

> **Textual qualification.** Working bilingual edition; 108/113 Cairo printed pages recorded as source checked; five pages outstanding; no independent manuscript collation

Cairo 1912 printed page 15

KAL-015.01

This is the kalām section of the Tahdhīb.

KAL-015.02

And the text has been organized into six chapters.

KAL-015.03

Chapter One: Introduction.

KAL-015.04

Kalām is knowledge of religious doctrines derived from certain proofs.

KAL-015.05

Its subject is the knowable insofar as it is connected with that [purpose].

KAL-015.06

Knowledge is not susceptible of a [strict] definition.

KAL-015.07

It may instead be explained by such formulations as: the occurrence of a thing’s form in the intellect; or a firm, reality-conforming, settled belief; or a quality through which the thing mentioned becomes disclosed to the one in whom [that quality] …

Cairo 1912 printed page 16

KAL-016.01

… subsists; or apprehension of a composite or of a universal. These [different formulations] call attention to differences in technical usage.

KAL-016.02

The reality of rational inquiry (naẓar) is the soul’s movement among intelligibles, going forth and returning, in order to acquire what was unknown.

KAL-016.03

That [inquiry] yields knowledge in at least some instances, even in divine matters, is evident immediately, without [needing further] inquiry.

KAL-016.04

Whoever denies it is obstinate, like the sophist who rejects sensory judgments, first principles, or both.

KAL-016.05

There is disagreement whether [knowledge results from rational inquiry] through customary concomitance, through generation (tawlīd), or necessarily.

KAL-016.06

Inquiry directed toward knowledge of God Most High is obligatory by scriptural text and consensus; for us this is because it is a prerequisite of the knowledge whose obligation is established by those means.

KAL-016.07

According to the Muʿtazila, [it is obligatory] because [knowledge] averts the harm associated with fear of punishment.

KAL-016.08

They object: if [inquiry] were obligatory only by revelation, it would not be legitimate to require examining a miracle, since no such obligation would exist before revelation’s authority had been established.

Cairo 1912 printed page 17

KAL-017.01

The reply is that what depends upon revelation is *knowledge of the obligation*, not the obligation itself.

KAL-017.02

Moreover, [knowledge of God] is the first of the obligations intended for their own sake, for the remaining obligations depend upon it.

KAL-017.03

Inquiry concerning it is a means to it, and so is obligatory for that reason.

KAL-017.04

A proof (dalīl) is something through consideration of which one can arrive at a judgment.

KAL-017.05

[The term] is sometimes restricted to what establishes certainty; in that usage an indicative sign (amāra) is contrasted with it.

KAL-017.06

If it depends on transmission, it is a transmitted proof; otherwise it is a rational proof.

KAL-017.07

With the help of corroborating indications, certainty may be obtained from it [transmission].

KAL-017.08

What has two alternatives equally balanced for reason is established only by transmission; but that upon which transmission itself depends can be established only by reason.

KAL-017.09

Chapter Two: General Matters.

KAL-017.10

The conception of existence is immediate; defining it by “being,” “actuality,” or “thinghood” is merely verbal.

KAL-017.11

The validity of dividing [existence] into the necessary [and other classes] rests upon its possession of a common meaning …

Cairo 1912 printed page 18

KAL-018.01

… and what is other than the necessary; [also] our certainty that it applies while remaining uncertain about a specific determination, and the completeness of the division into existent and nonexistent.

KAL-018.02

That [existence] is additional to quiddity **in the mind** is shown by the legitimacy of denying it of that quiddity, by the fact that predicating it of the quiddity is informative, and by our needing to establish that it belongs to the quiddity.

KAL-018.03

The philosophers hold that the reality of the Necessary is a particular existence subsisting in itself and sustaining what is other than itself, different in its very reality from contingent existence.

KAL-018.04

Accordingly, [the kind of existence under discussion] may be distinguished as attached to a quiddity conceptually, but not as a distinct thing in external reality, as the whiteness of a body shares with that body the incidental characterization of being.

KAL-018.05

[Existence] is predicated of existents analogically or by gradation (tashkīk), as light is predicated of lights.

KAL-018.06

As for the statement that in every case it is identical with the quiddity: this means that the two do not enjoy separately distinct actualizations in external reality; their distinction is in the intellect.

KAL-018.07

Existence is divided, properly speaking, into extramental existence and mental existence, and, figuratively, into verbal and written existence.

KAL-018.08

For, in utterance and writing, the human individual and the human quiddity are not present as they are in external reality …

Cairo 1912 printed page 19

KAL-019.01

… and in the intellect. In utterance and writing there is instead the name and its representation.

KAL-019.02

The proof for mental existence is that we apprehend what has no establishment outside the mind: we make affirmative judgments about impossibilities, and among concepts we find universals and among propositions real [universal] propositions.

KAL-019.03

If intellectual apprehension occurs through [a form’s] being present in the mind, that establishes the point; if it does not, it nevertheless necessarily entails a relation between the apprehender and what is apprehended.

KAL-019.04

That relation cannot have sheer negation as its term; and, since the relevant establishment is not extramental, it must be in the intellect.

KAL-019.05

This is a non-fundamental mode of existence that does not entail being qualified by the thing conceived: a believer conceives unbelief, but the mind is not thereby qualified by [the conceived] accidents, even contrary accidents.

KAL-019.06

Nor does this imply external existence for the impossible, as though its mental existence were located externally in the manner of water in a house.

KAL-019.07

What is understood by existence and thinghood is only establishment (thubūt), and by nonexistence only negation (nafy).

KAL-019.08

The nonexistent is not a thing, nor established; there is no intermediate [category] between it and the existent.

KAL-019.09

Some affirm the two [considerations] jointly and separately, calling an intermediary position a state (ḥāl), and also maintain … [continued on p. 20].

Cairo 1912 printed page 20

KAL-020.01

… existence one of those [intermediate states], arguing that if [existence itself] existed an infinite regress would ensue, while if it were nonexistent it would bear its own contradictory.

KAL-020.02

The reply is that its existence is itself, and its contradictory is nonexistence (ʿadam), not the nonexistent (maʿdūm).

KAL-020.03

They contend that nonexistent objects are distinguishable, while distinction cannot be intelligible without some kind of establishment.

KAL-020.04

They further argue that possibility has a positive character: one distinguishes what possesses possibility from what does not, and the subject to which possibility belongs must therefore be established.

KAL-020.05

We answer: differentiation resides only in the intellect; otherwise the assertion would be overturned by impossible objects and imaginary composites.

KAL-020.06

Moreover, the distinction between possibility and negated possibility can itself be affirmed even on the hypothesis that [the latter] is negated.

KAL-020.07

Both existence and nonexistence may function as predicates, and each may also function as a copula or connective.

KAL-020.08

Affirmative predication requires the two terms to be identical as to the subject [or referent] for it to be true, and different in conception for it to be informative.

KAL-020.09

The truth of affirmative predication consists in its agreement with what obtains in the matter itself (nafs al-amr). By this is meant what one understands from saying “This matter is such-and-such in itself,” apart from any person’s judgment or apprehension.

KAL-020.10

Section. A thing’s quiddity is that by which the question “What is it?” is answered. It can be considered under the condition of something additional, and is then called mixed; its existence is beyond dispute. Or [considered] under the condition …

Cairo 1912 printed page 21

KAL-021.01

… of nothing additional, and is then called the abstract [quiddity]. It does not exist in minds, much less among extramental individuals.

KAL-021.02

Or [quiddity] may be taken without stipulating anything; this is more inclusive than the mixed consideration. It exists as being those very things, not as a distinct constituent of them, since there is no real otherness; such a distinction obtains only in the intellect.

KAL-021.03

If [quiddity] is considered as the subject of universality, it is the natural universal. What actually exists is the subject of that characterization, not the mentally attributed accidents as separately existing things; the concrete instances are individuals.

KAL-021.04

A quiddity is also spoken of as taken on condition of nothing additional; in this use it becomes the matter of the individual and is prior to it in both modes of existence.

KAL-021.05

There is no doubt that composite quiddities exist, and they must ultimately terminate in simple [quiddities].

KAL-021.06

In a genuine composite, the dependence of some parts upon others is necessary, unlike a composite constituted merely by consideration.

KAL-021.07

Whoever disputes the quiddity’s being made means that its being made is among the concomitants of existence, like the finitude of bodies, rather than of quiddity, like the evenness of four; otherwise the contingent’s need for a cause is evident.

Cairo 1912 printed page 22

KAL-022.01

Section: On Individuation (taʿayyun).

KAL-022.02

Individuals of a species are distinguished by accidents, which may ultimately terminate in what supplies materiality.

KAL-022.03

Thus, in summary, individuation and particularization may be identified with that materiality or its source, with the individual’s being such that it cannot be shared, or simply with its not admitting sharing.

KAL-022.04

“Negative” may mean what is nonexistent, a related privation, or something whose very concept includes nonexistence; “positive” is the opposite.

KAL-022.05

What is real (ḥaqīqī) has establishment in the fact itself without admixture of supposition or stipulation; the considerational (iʿtibārī) is otherwise.

KAL-022.06

There is no doubt that individuation is either positive or negative …

Cairo 1912 printed page 23

KAL-023.01

… real or considerational.

KAL-023.02

Individuation must be referred either to a voluntary capable agent, to extramental existence, or to other causes.

KAL-023.03

Examples are the quiddity itself, or the matter individuated by accidents that attach to it according to the succession of dispositions.

KAL-023.04

Section: Necessity, impossibility and possibility are intelligibles arising from …

Cairo 1912 printed page 24

KAL-024.01

… the relation of a concept to a quiddity, whether simple or composite. Their apprehension is immediate.

KAL-024.02

Defining these through such expressions as the necessity of existence, necessity of nonexistence, or the absence of necessity on either side is merely verbal.

KAL-024.03

Each of the first two [necessity and impossibility] divides into intrinsic and derivative kinds.

KAL-024.04

What is called intrinsically necessary may be necessary in its own existence—namely God Most High—or necessary with respect to something else, as the evenness of four is.

KAL-024.05

Among things described as impossible, one is impossible in itself, such as a partner to the Creator; another is impossible with respect to something else, such as four’s being odd.

KAL-024.06

In the derivative kind, a contingent thing is necessary in respect of its being when it exists and impossible [to be existing] when it does not exist.

KAL-024.07

[Possibility] can be taken as denying the necessity of existence or of nonexistence; this is called general possibility, embracing particular possibility and necessity of the opposite alternative.

KAL-024.08

It may also be considered with respect to the future, and is then called future possibility.

KAL-024.09

The readiness of matter for something to arise, as the requisite conditions are realized one after another, is called dispositional possibility. This is what is intended …

Cairo 1912 printed page 25

KAL-025.01

The person who argues that every originated thing needs matter as the subject of its possibility, and a duration in which events succeed one another, establishes this only if one concedes that every originated thing is possible in precisely this sense.

KAL-025.02

The contingent’s need for an efficient determinant is necessary [knowledge], because one of its alternatives cannot prevail without a preponderating ground.

KAL-025.03

This is distinct from an agent’s freely selecting one of two equivalent options rather than the other, solely through the particular determination of will.

KAL-025.04

For instance, a fleeing person takes one of two routes and a hungry person eats one of two loaves.

KAL-025.05

If it is said: prior to the causal operation, in the state of existence, producing the effect would be producing what already exists; and in the state of nonexistence it would combine contradictories.

KAL-025.06

We reply: what is impossible is producing an already-produced thing through a *second* production. The ground of causal dependence is [variously held to be] possibility or origination, and each view has its argument.

KAL-025.07

The meaning of dependence is that existence, nonexistence, or the persistence of either depends upon something.

KAL-025.08

No intrinsic precedence or preferability of either alternative is intelligible …

Cairo 1912 printed page 26

KAL-026.01

… only in the sense of a kind of inclination toward existence or nonexistence, not reaching the point of necessity.

KAL-026.02

Even such an intrinsic tendency must be denied: otherwise the opposite alternative could not obtain, because it would entail the absence of the supposed intrinsic preference.

KAL-026.03

The existence of a possible thing is surrounded by two necessitations: one prior and one subsequent.

KAL-026.04

For unless its existence becomes necessitated it does not come to exist, because one alternative cannot prevail without a determinant.

KAL-026.05

While it exists, its nonexistence is impossible, because contradictories cannot occur together.

KAL-026.06

This does not negate voluntary choice.

KAL-026.07

And the three [modal qualifications]—indeed, everything that is predicated—[are considered] in respect of any individual that may be supposed. [The sentence continues on the next printed page.]

Cairo 1912 printed page 27

KAL-027.01

… of which [one can suppose] its concept, as with pre-eternity, origination, unity, plurality, persistence and individuation.

KAL-027.02

Such ascriptions are rational considerations; an infinite regress does not follow.

KAL-027.03

That something is necessary outside the mind means that, when it is apprehended as grounded in existence, the mind necessarily apprehends the intelligible called necessity. The same holds for the other [modal and general notions].

KAL-027.04

Section. Pre-eternity means not being preceded by another, which is essential priority; or not being preceded by nonexistence, which is temporal priority. Origination is the opposite.

KAL-027.05

Nothing besides God Most High is pre-eternal in itself; and [nothing] besides His attributes [is pre-eternal] in time.

KAL-027.06

The Muʿtazila are thereby committed to numerous states (aḥwāl), and among the philosophers to numerous [such cases; the second noun is left unexpressed in the print].

KAL-027.07

A pre-eternal thing is not referred to a voluntary agent, because the intention to bring something into being necessarily accompanies [its] nonexistence.

KAL-027.08

Its nonexistence is not possible, since it is necessary or referred to what is necessary in a necessitating manner.

Cairo 1912 printed page 28

KAL-028.00

Rule.

KAL-028.01

Priority, posteriority, and simultaneity may be by causality, nature, time, excellence, sensory or intellectual rank, conventional placement, natural placement, or by essence.

KAL-028.02

Therefore nonexistence’s precedence over an originated thing need not be *temporal*, so that the pre-eternity of time would be inferred.

KAL-028.03

Nor does it follow that [the originated thing] must possess dispositional possibility, such that matter would have to be pre-eternal for it.

KAL-028.04

Section. Unity and plurality are among the self-evident meanings.

KAL-028.05

Their predication is by gradation (tashkīk).

KAL-028.06

The aspect of unity may be constitutive, accidental, or relational.

KAL-028.07

Unity in genus is called *mujānasa* (sharing a genus), and unity in species *mumāthala* (sharing a species).

KAL-028.08

In quantity [it is called] equality; in quality, similarity.

KAL-028.09

With regard to a distinguishing property, [it is] correspondence (mushākala); with regard to boundaries or extremities, matching (muṭābaqa).

KAL-028.10

With regard to position, parallelism; and with regard to relation, proportion.

Cairo 1912 printed page 29

KAL-029.01

It is immediately necessary that two distinct things cannot be identical as one.

KAL-029.02

The purported proof that the difference between two quiddities or individuated identities is essential and cannot vanish is no more evident than the proposition to be proved.

KAL-029.03

A further argument claims that the two are either both existent, both nonexistent, or different in that respect; no [numerical] identity is thereby established.

KAL-029.04

This is countered [with the supposition] that both exist by one existence which is the very two existences having become one.

KAL-029.05

Otherness (ghayriyya) is the contrary of identity (huwahuwiyya); yet the appellation “two others” is sometimes restricted to two existents capable of separation.

KAL-029.06

Thus a part, in relation to its whole, is neither simply identical with it nor other than it; likewise an attribute in relation to what it qualifies.

KAL-029.07

Hence it can be correct to say “There is nothing in the house other than Zayd,” or “other than ten,” even if their parts and certain nonpredicable attributes are there.

KAL-029.08

So the intended meaning is not that it is “not identical” in the conceptual sense, and “not other” in the sense of …

Cairo 1912 printed page 30

KAL-030.01

… existence. Similarity is sharing the essential attributes; consequently, two distinct things need not be contraries.

KAL-030.02

There is disagreement about whether they must be other than one another and incapable of coexisting.

KAL-030.03

Contrariety (taḍādd) is the condition of two meanings such that, of themselves, they cannot both belong to one subject in the same respect.

KAL-030.04

According to the philosophers, two distinct things are alike if they share the entire quiddity, but different in kind otherwise.

KAL-030.05

They are opposed when they cannot coexist in one subject in the same respect. If both are positive, and the conception of one is made by reference to the other, they are correlatives; otherwise, they are contraries.

KAL-030.06

If they are not both positive existents, and the subject’s preparedness for the positive member is stipulated—whether individually, by species, or by proximate or remote genus—the opposition is that of possession and privation.

KAL-030.07

Otherwise the opposition is affirmation and negation.

KAL-030.08

The greatest possible difference is sometimes required for contrariety: this is called contrariety in the strict sense, while the former is the customary sense.

KAL-030.09

Some make receptivity for the positive form at that very time a condition of possession and privation, calling that the customary use and the former the strict use.

KAL-030.10

Unity and plurality are not opposites in the same sense, because their subjects differ and one is constituted in terms of the other.

Cairo 1912 printed page 31

KAL-031.01

Section: On Cause and Effect.

KAL-031.02

A cause is that upon which a thing depends.

KAL-031.03

If the cause is intrinsic [to the thing], the thing’s being necessitated together with it is either in actuality, in which case it is a formal cause, or in potentiality, in which case it is a material cause.

KAL-031.04

If the cause lies outside the thing, the thing is either [brought about] by it, in which case it is an efficient cause, or is for its sake, in which case it is a final cause.

KAL-031.05

Conditions and instruments are referred back to the efficient agent.

KAL-031.06

The totality of that upon which a thing depends is called its complete cause.

KAL-031.07

When the agent [together with all that its action requires] is complete, the effect must exist, because [its] becoming actual without a determinant is impossible.

KAL-031.08

And conversely [the existence of an effect requires its complete cause], because dependence is among the concomitants of possibility.

KAL-031.09

An effect can continue to exist when the antecedent causes have passed away only in the case of preparatory causes, such as a son after his father, or a building after its builder.

KAL-031.10

The cause responsible for bringing a thing into existence may differ from the cause of its persistence.

KAL-031.11

The numerical unity of an effect entails the unity of its efficient cause, since it is impossible for it simultaneously to be dependent and independent …

Cairo 1912 printed page 32

KAL-032.01

… but the converse does not hold, since everything ultimately depends upon the Necessary Existent, Most High, directly.

KAL-032.02

The argument that if only one thing proceeds from one source, the causal series and the cause between every pair of things would become identical is weak.

KAL-032.03

The opponent argues that, if two things proceeded from it, its being source of one would differ from its being source of the other.

KAL-032.04

If either of these source-relations entered into [its essence], it would be composite; otherwise an infinite regress would ensue.

KAL-032.05

The reply is that [these differences in being-source] are intellectual considerations, and that the same objection arises even when a single effect proceeds.

KAL-032.06

Their further claim is that what is intended is this: whenever the effect is multiplied, the agent is multiplied as well, even if only with respect to an aspect of agency.

KAL-032.07

For the assertion that its agency toward this is other than its agency toward that establishes nothing [to the point].

KAL-032.08

Nor does this fit the principle on which [the philosophers] based their argument: that a simple source cannot produce multiple effects.

KAL-032.09

And [they argue further] that a simple efficient agent cannot be …

Cairo 1912 printed page 33

KAL-033.01

… receptive [to the effect], since acting and receiving are two distinct considerations.

KAL-033.02

It is argued that the efficient cause bears a relation of necessity, while the recipient bears a relation of possibility.

KAL-033.03

Even if this is granted, the answer is that necessity and non-necessity in different respects are not incompatible.

KAL-033.04

Section. The actions of bodily powers may persist indefinitely by God’s creation.

KAL-033.05

According to the philosophers, these must be finite in intensity, duration and number.

KAL-033.06

For forced motion differs according to differences in the recipient, whereas natural motion differs according to differences in the agent.

KAL-033.07

Thus, if the two motions are supposed equal at their starting point, they must differ at the other end.

KAL-033.08

The response, even granting the causal influence [of corporeal power], is that the proof succeeds only if power is proportional to the magnitude of the body.

KAL-033.09

Section. Circular dependence is impossible: it consists in a thing’s depending on what itself depends upon that very thing.

KAL-033.10

For it is immediately necessary that a thing cannot precede itself.

KAL-033.11

Infinite regress is an endless ascent through things bearing the relations of cause and effect, since the productive cause …

Cairo 1912 printed page 34

KAL-034.01

… the independently sufficient ground of the whole cannot be the whole itself, nor a part of it, on pain of circularity; rather it must be external to the whole, and necessary.

KAL-034.02

That external necessary cause necessitates one of the members of the collection, and thus the regress terminates.

KAL-034.03

We may also take from the series a totality shorter by one member, and then align the two collections.

KAL-034.04

If each member of the complete series corresponds to a member of the deficient series, the whole would equal its proper part.

KAL-034.05

If not, the deficient series terminates, and so does the supposedly complete series.

KAL-034.06

Because the series contains a purely dependent effect, it must also contain a purely independent cause if [its members’ causal statuses] are to balance.

KAL-034.07

For we may consider each higher member as two in respect of its characterizations as both cause and effect.

KAL-034.08

Then, aligning the series considered under the attributes of causehood and effecthood, the necessary priority of the cause entails an excess of causehood and termination.

KAL-034.09

Furthermore, if [the number] admits division into two equal parts it is even; otherwise odd. In either case it is one less than what is above it, and the two [sequences] would accordingly be finite.

Cairo 1912 printed page 35

KAL-035.01

Conclusion. The term “form” may be applied to any configuration in a receptive subject that is one either essentially or by consideration.

KAL-035.02

Matter is its receptive substrate, as the body is the substrate of whiteness.

KAL-035.03

An end is that toward which an action tends, even when it has no [real] aspect of causing the action or of the action’s depending upon it.

KAL-035.04

Indeed, even when the agent has no intention [toward that end].

KAL-035.05

Since, according to us, God alone brings things into existence, the meaning of causality and efficacy among contingent things is customary occasioning (al-tasabbub al-ʿādī).

KAL-035.06

Chapter Three: Accidents. It contains several sections. Section One.

KAL-035.07

An existent that was not preceded by nonexistence is pre-eternal; otherwise it is originated.

KAL-035.08

If it is spatially located through itself, it is a substance; if through dependence upon another, it is an accident characterized by spatial location—[continued on the following page].

Cairo 1912 printed page 36

KAL-036.01

... such as life, knowledge and acts of perception, or not confined [to a single subject], such as spatial states and sensible conditions.

KAL-036.02

The philosophers say: if an existent’s existence is not in a subject (lā fī mawḍūʿ), then it is a substance; otherwise it is an accident.

KAL-036.03

This means that it has no need of a subject that sustains it; that sustaining locus is called a “subject” (mawḍūʿ).

KAL-036.04

The genera of accidents are quantity, quality, place (where), relation, time (when), position, possession, acting and being acted upon.

KAL-036.05

That an accident cannot subsist by itself, or subsist in more than one individual bearer either intrinsically or collectively—as in the unity of ten or the life of an aggregate structure—is immediately evident.

KAL-036.06

In cases such as proximity, adjacency, and composition, there is a plurality of accidents [despite the print’s awkward singular «العرض»].

KAL-036.07

Its transfer from one subject to another is impossible, because its existence in itself is precisely its existence …

Cairo 1912 printed page 37

KAL-037.01

… in its bearer, and because its individuation is only through that bearer.

KAL-037.02

The arising of a like accident in an adjoining locus has been mistaken for a transfer. Whether an accident can be transferred is disputed, because inherence (qiyām) is variously understood as dependence in occupying place or as a qualifying attachment to a subject.

KAL-037.03

Most kalām theologians maintain that an accident cannot persist through two instants of time.

KAL-037.04

[They argue] that its concept implies this; that persistence would require an additional accident of persistence inhering in it; and that its cessation would be impossible, since it would occur either by itself (which is impossible) or through the removal of a condition (leading to regress).

KAL-037.05

Or [the accident’s cessation would occur] through the arrival of its contrary—yielding a circle—or through an agent, in which case sheer nonexistence would become an effect. All these arguments are weak.

Cairo 1912 printed page 38

KAL-038.01

Section: Quantity is an accident which admits division intrinsically, that is, supposing a part distinct from another part.

KAL-038.02

It is discrete if its parts have no common boundary; this is number.

KAL-038.03

It is continuous if they do have one. If it is nonpersistent [in its parts], it is time; otherwise it is a magnitude: a line, surface, or mathematical body.

KAL-038.04

Considered with an added relation or determination, these are called length, breadth, and depth.

KAL-038.05

According to the theologians, number is a considerational notion; spatial magnitudes are either aggregated substances or their boundaries and terminations.

KAL-038.06

Time, in the theologians’ account, is imaginary: neither the past nor the future exists, while existence of a present interval would require a first [indivisible] part.

KAL-038.07

For the priority of its parts would itself be temporal, generating a regress. Were time to exist, its nonexistence after its existence would be impossible because that would itself be temporal; this would entail its necessity despite its composition and contradiction.

KAL-038.08

The response distinguishes the existence of past and future from the absence of something at the present instant: absence at that instant does not entail absolute nonexistence. It also invokes priority by essence and the subsequent nonexistence on the past side. Even if the disputed premise is conceded, the impossibility of nonexistence after existence does not negate possibility.

KAL-038.09

The philosophers say that time is a continuous extended existent subject to descriptions of pastness and futurity, and intrinsically to priority and posteriority, such that …

Cairo 1912 printed page 39

KAL-039.01

… what comes before does not become after, nor what comes after become before. [Time] is immediately known even to ordinary people; hence they divide it into years, months, days, and hours.

KAL-039.02

As to its reality, one account makes time the magnitude of the motion of the outermost celestial sphere; because it admits degrees of greater and lesser duration, it is a quantity.

KAL-039.03

Because it cannot be composed of successive, indivisible instants, time is continuous; and because it does not remain fixed, it is the measure of a non-abiding nature—namely motion. [Cairo 1912, p. 39: طبيعة rather than the previous working transcription هيئة; the locus is not independently manuscript-collated.]

KAL-039.04

Since time cannot simply cease, the philosophers associate its measure with circular movement, which can be continuous; rectilinear movement, by contrast, comes to an end. [The precise linking verb of the Cairo print awaits a second direct Tahdhīb witness.]

KAL-039.05

Because all motions are measured by it, it is the measure associated with the fastest of them. The account rests upon the philosophers’ principles.

KAL-039.06

Another account calls time a known renewed occurrence by which an imagined renewed occurrence is measured.

KAL-039.07

Some ancients hold that [time] is an independent substance whose existence is certain even in the absence of bodies and motion.

KAL-039.08

Section: On Place. It has been said to be the inner surface of the containing body, in contact with the outer surface …

Cairo 1912 printed page 40

KAL-040.01

… of the contained body.

KAL-040.02

Others say it is the extension penetrated by the body’s magnitude. The indications include equality between place and what occupies it, that every body has a place, and the possibility of describing a bird as at rest within moving air or a stone as at rest within flowing water.

KAL-040.03

All these indications support the second account [that place is an extension penetrated by a body]. Can a place be empty of an occupant?

KAL-040.04

Some answer yes: if we raise a perfectly smooth plate from another similar plate, the space between them must initially be empty.

KAL-040.05

Likewise, if one side of a sealed skin-vessel whose neck and pores are closed is raised away from the other, its interior would be empty.

KAL-040.06

Others say no: otherwise the presence and absence of a resisting medium would be equivalent …

KAL-040.07

Suppose a body crosses a farsakh of void in one hour, and the same distance through a filled medium in two hours …

Cairo 1912 printed page 41

KAL-041.01

… and through another medium half as resistant as the first, it would [by this assumption] take one hour, since differences in time track differences in resistance.

KAL-041.02

Other indications are flesh rising into a cupping cup, water in a tube, and water’s failure to descend from a vessel with its mouth sealed, as observed in devices arranged from both sides.

KAL-041.03

Section: On Quality. An accident which, in itself, admits neither division nor relation.

KAL-041.04

Its divisions according to induction are four.

KAL-041.05

The first class is sensible qualities. The fundamental tangible qualities are heat, cold, moisture and dryness.

KAL-041.06

The term “hot” may also be applied to what produces heat, whether by first coming into contact with the body …

Cairo 1912 printed page 42

KAL-042.01

… as [in heavenly influences].

KAL-042.02

As for the innate heat by which life is sustained, some call it fiery, others heavenly, and others distinct from both.

KAL-042.03

Another such quality is iʿtimād, meaning a perceptible pushing against or resistance (mudāfaʿa).

KAL-042.04

Its kinds are sometimes made six by customary classification.

KAL-042.05

The natural [impetus] is either upward, namely lightness, or downward, namely heaviness; these two are contrary.

KAL-042.06

The philosophers call it inclination (mayl) and distinguish forced, natural, and voluntary kinds.

KAL-042.07

Its principle either comes from outside, in which case it is forced; or, if it proceeds from awareness, it is voluntary; otherwise natural. Thus the plant’s inclination toward protrusion and increase is said to be natural.

KAL-042.08

The fundamental visible qualities are colors and lights; each has several kinds.

KAL-042.09

But every variety of colour has a distinctive name. [The comparison with light continues on the next page.]

Cairo 1912 printed page 43

KAL-043.01

… unlike light. Some conceive whiteness as the mixing of light with transparent bodies, as in snow, foam, and powdered glass.

KAL-043.02

This does not prevent [whiteness] from being a genuine quality arising through causes.

KAL-043.03

Light, if it belongs intrinsically to its subject, is essential light, as with the sun, and is called radiance (ḍiyāʾ). Accidental light arising from facing an intrinsically luminous source is first-order; otherwise it is second- or third-order.

KAL-043.04

Darkness is the privation of light. Its positive apprehensibility does not entail that darkness is an existing quality. How could it? Were it such a quality, it would obstruct a person sitting in a cave from seeing outside, just as in the reverse direction, since there is no relevant difference.

KAL-043.05

Light spreading from an intrinsically luminous body, such as the sun, is called a ray; reflected illumination, as from a mirror, is brilliance.

KAL-043.06

It has been imagined that light is composed of small bodies separating from the luminous object and reaching what is illuminated.

KAL-043.07

The reason given is that light arising from a high luminous source, from a moving source, or from something between source and illuminated object gives the impression that light moves downwards, upwards, or by reflection.

KAL-043.08

Some say that color is unseen in darkness because light is a condition for the color’s existence; the correct position is that it is a condition for *seeing* the color.

KAL-043.09

As for audible things …

Cairo 1912 printed page 44

KAL-044.01

… they are sounds. Their proximate cause is the wave-like movement of air resulting from impact or separation.

KAL-044.02

Evidence that sound exists outside the ear canal, and that our sensation is directed to it there, is our perception of its direction, including when it comes from the opposite side, and our ability to distinguish a near sound from a distant one.

KAL-044.03

The view that sound is heard through arriving air is supported by the way it bends with winds and how its hearability can depend upon that medium.

KAL-044.04

When [a sound] returns after striking a smooth body, it is an echo (ṣadā).

KAL-044.05

When [a sound] acquires a quality by which it is audibly distinguished from another resembling it in highness or lowness of pitch, it is a letter (ḥarf).

KAL-044.06

A letter divides into a vowel-like sound, either short (the vowel movements) or prolonged (the long vowels), and a consonant. A consonant joined to a short vowel makes a short syllabic segment, or to a prolonged vowel a long segment.

KAL-044.07

As in the short and long utterances exemplified by the written sequences “la” and “lā”.

KAL-044.08

A composite of these sounds is called speech (kalām) or utterance (lafẓ).

KAL-044.09

Speech is sometimes reserved for meaningful utterance, and “wording” for what is compounded of articulatory segments.

KAL-044.10

One might suppose that utterance belongs to the category of quantity, since its whole can be measured by one of its parts. The reply is that this applies only incidentally (bi-l-ʿaraḍ).

KAL-044.11

The fundamental objects of taste are the nine tastes, and of smell the odors. The second [division of quality] consists of the qualities …

Cairo 1912 printed page 45

KAL-045.01

[These qualities are] psychic, called a settled disposition (malaka) when firmly rooted and a passing state (ḥāl) when not.

KAL-045.02

One such quality is life, the principle of the power of sensation and motion.

KAL-045.03

Life does not require a balanced temperament, bodily structure, or spirit as conditions, although it may cease when they are absent.

KAL-045.04

Death is its cessation; another view makes death a positive quality contrary to life.

KAL-045.05

Death is sometimes applied simply to the absence of life, as in an inanimate thing.

KAL-045.06

Among them is apprehension: the distinguishing, presence, and manifestation of a thing to the intellect by its very reality, as with the soul and its attributes.

KAL-045.07

Or apprehension may occur through its abstracted representation, as with material things, or through a representation acquired without such abstraction, as in immaterial things and nonexistents.

KAL-045.08

Although these representations differ from the identity through which a subject is intrinsically qualified, their occurrence in the intellect is not the inherence of an accident in a subject.

KAL-045.09

Consequently the apprehender need not acquire the property apprehended: the generous man may conceive the miser without becoming miserly.

KAL-045.10

Conversely, he may actually be generous without at that moment conceiving generosity.

KAL-045.11

Those who deny intellectual existence construe cognition as a bare relation or a quality bearing a relation.

KAL-045.12

They then have difficulty explaining knowledge of nonexistent things and must concede a representation in the case of nonexistents, indeed in all cases.

KAL-045.13

This means that the nonexistent has a non-fundamental kind of existence; the [cognitive form], insofar as it subsists in the mind, is knowledge, while insofar as considered in its own identity it is the known—unlike the existent [as continued on p. 46].

Cairo 1912 printed page 46

KAL-046.01

For the act or content of knowledge is what lies in the mind, while what is known is what is external.

KAL-046.02

The kinds of apprehension are sensation, imagination, estimation, and intellection.

KAL-046.03

The word knowledge may be applied to apprehension generally, to the latter three kinds, or to the last of them alone.

KAL-046.04

It may also be reserved for firm, reality-conforming, stable assent.

KAL-046.05

Assent lacking firmness is called opinion (ẓann); lacking correspondence, compound ignorance; and lacking stability, belief or conviction (iʿtiqād).

KAL-046.06

Doubt and estimation [in the restricted sense] are counted under conception rather than certain assent.

KAL-046.07

When a cognitive form drops from attention, its complete loss is forgetting; if the form remains without being recalled, that is inadvertence.

KAL-046.08

Simple ignorance is privation of knowledge; compound ignorance is contrary to it, although some call it a quality of the same general kind.

KAL-046.09

For [on this account] accidents do not differ by [mere] correspondence (ṭibāq).

KAL-046.10

Created knowledge can be potential, namely preparedness to know, or actual.

KAL-046.11

Actual knowledge is either summary—by grasping a simple consideration which serves as the source of detailed cognitions—or detailed, by considering those particulars explicitly.

KAL-046.12

Acquired knowledge may become immediate; whether an originally immediate cognition may become acquired is disputed.

KAL-046.13

There is likewise a disagreement about the multiplication of knowledge with the multiplication of its objects; its seat is the heart.

KAL-046.14

There is no dispute here that instruments may mediate cognition of particulars.

Cairo 1912 printed page 47

KAL-047.01

The condition of moral accountability is the faculty obtained through cognition of certain immediate truths.

KAL-047.02

It enables one to acquire demonstrative knowledge and to distinguish good from bad matters.

KAL-047.03

Among the psychic qualities is will: like other immediately experienced states, it is easy to recognize but difficult to define.

KAL-047.04

Will differs from appetite in its occurrence and its intensity, and in that will is attached to the apprehensive faculty whereas appetite is attached to nature.

KAL-047.05

One view identifies will with belief in benefit, another with the inclination following such belief, and another with knowledge of what the knowing subject regards as perfection and good.

KAL-047.06

Defining it as a quality through which an agent selects one of two possible acts—doing and not doing—does not disclose its essence.

KAL-047.07

Al-Ashʿarī is reported to maintain that willing one thing is identical with aversion [to its contrary].

KAL-047.08

Power (qudra) is a quality producing an effect in accordance with will, or the principle of acts of different kinds.

KAL-047.09

The discussion now turns to the more inclusive concept of power (quwwa) …

Cairo 1912 printed page 48

KAL-048.01

Power (quwwa) is broader: it is a principle of producing change in something else insofar as it is other, whether intentionally or without intention.

KAL-048.02

Within each of the intentional and non-intentional divisions, the effects are either diverse or not diverse; this yields four combinations.

KAL-048.03

These four cases, in order, are: animal power (intentional, with diverse effects); celestial power (intentional, with effects of one kind); vegetative power (without intention, with diverse effects); and elemental power (without intention, with effects of one kind).

KAL-048.04

According to the doctrine under discussion, created capacity accompanies the act, rather than preceding it, because accidents cannot endure.

KAL-048.05

The response is that [a created power] can persist through the successive renewal of like instances, as knowledge and other qualities that precede the act do.

KAL-048.06

They argue that if capacity existed only during an act, one would have to produce something already existing and moral obligation would become impossible.

KAL-048.07

The reply invokes the earlier distinction and holds that moral obligation is sufficiently possible if an act is generally within the scope of capacity.

KAL-048.08

An unbeliever’s act of believing is an example, unlike bringing a body into being. On the first account, someone prevented from acting is not considered able, as in the case of a paralysed person.

KAL-048.09

Likewise, it is maintained that one particular capacity does not attach to two distinct possible acts.

KAL-048.10

A more precise view distinguishes a general faculty capable of diverse acts, whether through efficacy or through customary occasioning.

KAL-048.11

Such a faculty can persist with the act, before it and after it.

KAL-048.12

But the complete conjunction of all conditions of efficacy occurs only with the act itself. Incapacity is said to be contrary to capacity.

KAL-048.13

On the view that inability is the contrary of power, inability relates only to what is existent. Another view calls it privation of a faculty, since the challenged person’s inability is certainly [the inability to produce its like, continued on p. 49].

Cairo 1912 printed page 49

KAL-049.01

[The incapacity at issue] is an incapacity to produce the like of [what is challenged]; to make the word equivocal between the two meanings conflicts with linguistic usage.

KAL-049.02

Capacity is contrary to settled character (khuluq), since actions proceeding from character occur without deliberation.

KAL-049.03

Whether sleep is contrary to power remains disputed.

KAL-049.04

Further psychic qualities include pleasure and pain.

KAL-049.05

They are sometimes explained as apprehending what is agreeable and disagreeable precisely as such; on this account they are kinds of apprehension.

KAL-049.06

This holds if the intention is the actual feeling or encounter [of the appropriate object].

KAL-049.07

Others maintain that pleasure consists in departure from a state contrary to nature.

KAL-049.08

Each of pleasure and pain can be sensory or intellectual; the intellectual kind is stronger.

KAL-049.09

Sensible suffering associated with the sense of touch is called ache or bodily pain (waja‘).

KAL-049.10

Also health and disease: health is a stable condition or passing state from which a subject’s actions arise in sound form.

KAL-049.11

Disease is a contrary condition, whether stable or passing; some consider it privation of the sound faculty.

KAL-049.12

By a loose extension of usage, both health and disease may be included among sensible qualities.

KAL-049.13

If, in defining health and disease respectively, one requires the soundness of all functions and the impairment of all functions, an intermediate state between them must be acknowledged, as in children and the elderly. Otherwise there is no such intermediate state.

KAL-049.14

The third class is qualities particular to quantities, such as straightness and curvature—[of a line; continued on p. 50].

Cairo 1912 printed page 50

KAL-050.01

[Straightness and curvature belong] to a line; concavity and convexity to a surface; and evenness and oddness to number.

KAL-050.02

Another instance is outward configuration (khilqa), meaning the combined shape and colour in virtue of which a thing is described as beautiful or ugly.

KAL-050.03

Another is angle: the configuration in which two lines enclose a surface at their meeting.

KAL-050.04

The claim that an angle is a surface enclosed by two lines which meet at a point uses the term loosely.

KAL-050.05

The fourth class comprises dispositional qualities: an intense readiness to be affected, called weakness, as in a susceptibility to disease; or a resistance to being affected, called strength, as in a disposition to health.

KAL-050.06

Chapter on where: it is a thing’s occupancy of a spatial region.

KAL-050.07

If the occupancy of one substance is considered in relation to another, then, if a third can be interposed, the two are separated; otherwise they are conjoined.

KAL-050.08

Without that comparative consideration, if occupancy was preceded by occupancy of the same region, it is rest; if by occupancy of a different region, it is motion.

KAL-050.09

Thus the occupancy occurring at the instant of origination falls outside both [motion and rest]; another opinion counts it as rest.

Cairo 1912 printed page 51

KAL-051.01

The correct position is that the real nature of occupancy is one in all the cases, and their difference arises only through the respects under which it is considered.

KAL-051.02

So one and the same individual state may count as separation, conjunction, motion and rest under different considerations.

KAL-051.03

To say that these occupancies are contrary is to say that they cannot coexist when their relevant conditions are actual.

KAL-051.04

“Motion” may refer to what is actually realised: one occupancy following another in a different region.

KAL-051.05

Or it may refer to what is imagined: a continuous series of successive occupancies without stable remaining.

KAL-051.06

If dwelling or remaining is not imposed as a condition of rest, then motion itself would be rest—or a plurality of rests.

KAL-051.07

There is hesitation over whether rest is the second occupancy alone or the two occupancies together.

KAL-051.08

The correct position is that the inner parts of a moving body are also moving.

KAL-051.09

A person standing while the wind blows or water flows over him remains at rest.

KAL-051.10

The uncertainty depends on a corresponding uncertainty concerning the nature of spatial region.

KAL-051.11

The philosophers’ account of motion is introduced here and continues onto the following page.

Cairo 1912 printed page 52

KAL-052.01

[They say that motion is] coming out of potentiality into actuality gradually, little by little, rather than all at once; this is grounded in the supposed self-evidence of these notions.

KAL-052.02

What exists of motion is the body’s continuously being intermediate between its starting point and its end.

KAL-052.03

The intellectually conceived connected and extended entirety of motion, on the other hand, is an imaginary construction.

KAL-052.04

Motion also requires six conditions or considerations: that from which it proceeds, that to which it proceeds, that in which it occurs, what it is [the print has «وهو»], that to which it belongs, and time. [The technical fourth item remains for independent witness collation.]

KAL-052.05

Motion in the category of place is obvious; motion in position is exemplified by the revolution of the celestial sphere.

KAL-052.06

Motion in quantity includes growth, wasting, rarefaction and condensation.

Cairo 1912 printed page 53

KAL-053.01

Motion in quality is illustrated by grapes becoming black and water becoming hot.

KAL-053.02

This is said while affirming that the quality was not already present in the subject and had not merely arrived upon it from without.

KAL-053.03

Motion may belong primarily to a thing, as the motion of a ship does, or accidentally, as the motion of its passenger does.

KAL-053.04

If the moving cause is external, motion is forced. If internal, it is voluntary when accompanied by intention and awareness, and otherwise natural.

KAL-053.05

This includes growth, pulsation, and breathing insofar as the occurrence of those activities in general is necessary.

KAL-053.06

But insofar as their particular occurrences can be varied in their timing, they are voluntary.

KAL-053.07

The assertion that natural motion must always be descending or ascending applies only to elemental simple bodies.

KAL-053.08

Motion has specific unity through the unity of what it takes place in, what it proceeds from, and what it proceeds to; numerical unity through the unity of everything other than the mover; and generic unity through what it takes place in.

KAL-053.09

Motions are contrary when their points of origin and their termini are contrary—for example blackening and whitening, or ascent and descent.

KAL-053.10

Motion is divisible according to the divisions of time, the category in which motion occurs, and that to which motion belongs [«ما له»].

KAL-053.11

Among the concomitants of motion is a quality susceptible to degrees …

Cairo 1912 printed page 54

KAL-054.01

That quality is termed speed when intense and slowness when weak.

KAL-054.02

Slowness is not the interposition of moments of rest: motion cannot simply be absent when its complete determinant is present and the impediment has been removed.

KAL-054.03

That account would also imply disjunction in examples such as the motion of a ring in a mill, and an inconceivably greater number of moments of rest than movement for a flying bird.

KAL-054.04

The reply is that motion is due solely to God’s creation, and that separation followed by reunion is possible.

KAL-054.05

Because motions are renewed positive occurrences, they differ from rests, even if they are many thousands of times more numerous.

KAL-054.06

They say that rest must intervene between any two motions, for the instant of arrival differs from the instant of return. Without an interval of rest between them, two instants would follow immediately upon one another, entailing an indivisible [temporal] part.

KAL-054.07

It is answered that there is no such instant without a discontinuity; and objected that if it occurred it would lack a determinate cause or time.

KAL-054.08

[The opposing argument says] a descending mountain would have to halt on meeting an ascending mustard seed. The reply invokes the absence of motion as the cause.

KAL-054.09

It is further answered that the event occurs in a duration that is not actually divisible, and that the mustard seed is turned back by striking the air displaced by the mountain.

Cairo 1912 printed page 55

KAL-055.01

Chapter. If a body moves in two opposite directions, its distance from its starting point corresponds to the excess [of motion in one direction over the other]; otherwise it is at rest.

KAL-055.02

Rest, considered at an instant, is the persistence of the relevant relations; considered otherwise, it is the persistence of the same kind.

KAL-055.03

It is therefore opposed to motion; alternatively, it is said to be the absence of motion, and is accordingly a privation.

KAL-055.04

Rest may be natural, forced, or voluntary.

KAL-055.05

Different states of rest are contrary when the places in which they occur are contrary, as with rest in an upper and a lower location.

KAL-055.06

Chapter. Relation (iḍāfa) is a reciprocal reference (nisba munʿakisa), which is called a relative in the strict sense.

KAL-055.07

The complex composed of the relation and its subject is called a relative in the customary sense.

KAL-055.08

The two correlated relations may agree in their descriptions or differ.

KAL-055.09

Reciprocity can dispense with an overt relational particle, while the attribution of a relation can require a connecting expression.

KAL-055.10

Its ground can be a quality in both correlates—[continued on the next page].

Cairo 1912 printed page 56

KAL-056.01

—or in only one of them. Relation is predicable of every existent; its two terms are on a par as regards realization, application, existence and nonexistence, in mind and outside it, potentially and actually.

KAL-056.02

Most regard relation as something established by consideration; otherwise there would be a regress, since inherence itself is a relation, and that relation would itself have inherence.

KAL-056.03

It would follow that every nonexistent [item] has indefinitely many attributes through the relations it bears to everything besides itself.

KAL-056.04

It may be replied that negating the members individually does not entail negation of the universal considered as such.

KAL-056.05

The argument for their real existence based on our certainty that heaven is above and earth below, and that Zayd is a father and ʿAmr a son, even if the intellect did not consider these relations, is weak.

KAL-056.06

As to their genera, species, individuation, and contrariety, relations follow the subjects in which they are considered.

KAL-056.07

The category of “when” (matā) is the relation to time or to an instant.

KAL-056.08

Position (waḍʿ) is the condition of a body in which its parts stand in a relation among themselves or to things external to them.

KAL-056.09

Possession (milk) is the relation of a body to something enclosing it, or part of it, which moves when the body moves.

KAL-056.10

“Acting upon” is one thing’s exercising an effect upon another for as long as the process continues.

KAL-056.11

“Being acted upon” is undergoing another’s influence in the same way.

KAL-056.12

What remains once the process is settled, however, is a quality, a position, or something else [rather than action or passion].

KAL-056.13

Chapter Four: On Substances.

KAL-056.14

A substance, if divisible, is a body; the other [indivisible kind] is an atom. The philosophers then say: substance—[their alternative division continues on p.57].

Cairo 1912 printed page 57

KAL-057.01

If [substance] is capable of dimensions, it is a body; if not, then what belongs to a body as an actual component is form, as a potential component is matter; what is outside it but connected with it is soul; otherwise it is intellect.

KAL-057.02

Chapter. According to us, body is substance capable of division; this includes anything composed of two or more parts.

KAL-057.03

According to the Muʿtazila, it is what has breadth, depth, and length.

KAL-057.04

Hence what is arranged only along one or two dimensions is excluded, as is any composition with fewer than the minimum particles needed for a body—reckoned as eight, six, or four.

KAL-057.05

According to the philosophers, body is substance in which three mutually intersecting dimensions can be supposed at right angles.

KAL-057.06

They differ over whether that account is a strict definition or a descriptive characterization.

KAL-057.07

Furthermore, the divisions of simple body actually exist according to us, contrary to the philosophers.

KAL-057.08

Most of them hold that [body] is composed of matter, through which it admits division, and form, as indicated by its hypothesized extensions.

KAL-057.09

Others hold that a body is simple in itself, as it appears to sense.

KAL-057.10

Our argument is that, if what admits division were a single thing, its unity would itself be divisible—[continued on p.58].

Cairo 1912 printed page 58

KAL-058.01

—its unity would itself be divisible, and severance would amount to its destruction.

KAL-058.02

And a mountain could not be greater than a mustard seed if both possessed infinitely many actual parts.

KAL-058.03

Moreover, the extension of an actual body is finite; and time would [on the opposing account] fail to exist, for only its indivisible present exists, corresponding to motion and, through it, to the traversed distance.

KAL-058.04

Furthermore, a point is a line’s extremity; by a point a sphere touches a plane, and by a point one line stands upon another.

KAL-058.05

Its existence is thus [an instance of] something indivisible.

KAL-058.06

The number of [actual] parts must be finite: otherwise they could not be located between two termini, and neither a moving body could reach its goal nor a faster one catch a slower.

KAL-058.07

There are several arguments for finitude. First, what extends from [a part] in one direction differs from what extends in another.

KAL-058.08

Second, consider the contact of two parts. If their contact is throughout their entirety, [their combination has] no magnitude; otherwise [one of them] is divisible.

KAL-058.09

Third, suppose three [parts]; if the middle one prevents [the contact of the two outer ones —continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 59

KAL-059.01

—the two outer ones from meeting, it must be divisible; if it does not, there is no magnitude.

KAL-059.02

Fourth, if a part falls upon the junction of two other parts, all three would be divided.

KAL-059.03

Fifth, disjunction would follow in every body in which some part traverses one part or more [relative to another], as in the hoop of a millstone, the two arms of a three-armed compass, and a person’s heel in relation to the other extremities when that person turns around.

KAL-059.04

The supposition under discussion is supported from both sides [«مستظهر من الجانبين»; the precise technical force awaits another witness].

KAL-059.05

They say: if bodily continuity is not merely particles joining, and bodily separation not merely their parting, then the body has an extended identity that does not disappear through change of magnitudes.

KAL-059.06

This is the substance characterized by continuity and by the possibility of dimensions being posited in it; this is called form.

KAL-059.07

This [corporeal] form does not persist as the very same form upon separation; rather, it ceases and is succeeded by two connected identities.

KAL-059.08

There must therefore be something receptive of both continuity and discontinuity that persists in both conditions: what they call prime matter (hayūlā).

KAL-059.09

Others maintain that the thing capable of continuity and separation is the body itself and that continuity and separation occurring to it are accidents.

KAL-059.10

What is imagined to be an enduring extension is simply magnitude preserved through a succession of particular determinations.

KAL-059.11

Chapter. Those who affirm the indivisible part disagree whether it can receive life and its concomitants; whether a part can be placed upon the junction of two parts; and whether it is possible to make—[continued on p.60].

Cairo 1912 printed page 60

KAL-060.01

—a line made up of [indivisible] parts into a circle, and whether such a part has a shape; those who affirm the part disagree.

KAL-060.02

Some say its shape resembles a sphere, others a triangle, and others a square.

KAL-060.03

They agree that the [individual part] has no share of length, breadth, or depth, and that the nature of the parts is one.

KAL-060.04

Differences among bodies therefore result from their differing accidents, by the will of the freely choosing omnipotent agent; alternatively, differences of shape have been proposed.

KAL-060.05

Know that establishing the indivisible part blocks the route to many of the philosophers’ foundational doctrines and makes many religious principles easier to establish.

KAL-060.06

Chapter. The philosophers claim that bodies belong to distinct species by virtue of distinct specific forms, which account for their differing effects.

KAL-060.07

The theologians, however, maintain that bodies are alike and differ only through accidents deriving from the freely choosing omnipotent agent, since their constituent indivisible substances are alike.

KAL-060.08

Accordingly, anything possible for one [of these substances] is possible for another.

KAL-060.09

Further, these [bodies] endure as a matter of necessary judgment, yet perish according to the indication of the revealed text; and none of them is without … [the sentence continues on the next printed page].

Cairo 1912 printed page 61

KAL-061.01

—a shape, since it is finite, nor without spatial occupation, as is immediately evident; nor can it be without accidents and their opposites, such as motion and rest, conjunction and separation.

KAL-061.02

Several arguments are offered for the finitude of [spatial] dimensions.

KAL-061.03

First, if an unbounded extension existed, consider a sphere turned so that its diameter, initially parallel to that extension, approaches alignment with it. This would require a determinate point without an immediately preceding one [the geometrical inference still requires further checking].

KAL-061.04

Yet for every point posited, alignment at some point beyond it would be impossible before alignment occurred there.

KAL-061.05

Second, suppose two lines issuing from one point, like the legs of a triangle, such that the distance between them grows with their extension.

KAL-061.06

If the lines extended without end, the distance between them would likewise be without end.

KAL-061.07

Third, take a cubit away from a supposedly infinite extension and then superimpose the remaining extent upon the original.

KAL-061.08

Either each cubit in the complete series faces a cubit in the shortened series, in which case they would be equal, or not, in which case the [shortened] series must end.

KAL-061.09

An objection says that what lies south of a boundary differs from what lies north, so what is outside the world would not be sheer nothing; furthermore, a person at the world’s edge either can stretch out a hand—in which case there is distance beyond—or cannot, in which case something obstructs the act.

KAL-061.10

We reply: the first is sheer imagining, and inability to extend a hand may result from the absence of a necessary condition [not an external obstacle].

KAL-061.11

Moreover, the terminus of an extension, insofar as it is the endpoint of indication and the destination reached by a moving body, is a direction (jiha).

KAL-061.12

As related to a human being’s head, feet, back, belly, and hands, directions are enumerated as six; but there is no [such fixed enumeration—continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 62

KAL-062.01

—in reality. The naturally fixed directions above and below do not interchange; bodies are specified by their natures and properties.

KAL-062.02

Most philosophers hold that the celestial bodies are eternal, apart from particular positions and motions.

KAL-062.03

They hold that elemental bodies are eternal with respect to their matter and corporeal form at the specific level, and their specific forms at the generic level.

KAL-062.04

Some instead posit an eternal substratum—whether all the elements or earth, water, air, or fire—from which the others arise by rarefaction or condensation.

KAL-062.05

Others hold that heaven originated from vapour rising from that substratum, or from a different substance, or from small solid spherical bodies, differently shaped bodies, light and darkness, or isolated units.

KAL-062.06

These units then became points, then lines, then surfaces, and finally body.

KAL-062.07

We have several arguments [for the createdness of bodies]. First, body is never without accidents, which cannot persist; this applies particularly to motion and rest.

KAL-062.08

For when a body occupies a location, if that occupation was not preceded by occupation in a different location, it is rest; otherwise it is motion.

KAL-062.09

Each is liable to cessation, which is incompatible with pre-eternity.

KAL-062.10

The case of motion is evident. As for rest, every body is susceptible to motion, as is conceded and as the similarity of bodies shows, both from the outset—[continued on p. 63].

Cairo 1912 printed page 63

KAL-063.01

—to its endpoint.

KAL-063.02

If it is said that there may be motions without a first beginning, while their universal kind endures through successive originated particulars, we reply that this is refuted by the matching and correspondence arguments and by the fact that a universal exists only in its particulars.

KAL-063.03

Second, body is a locus of originated events, whereas nothing pre-eternal can be such a locus, as will be established.

KAL-063.04

Third, body is an effect of a choosing agent, as will follow from the proof that the Necessary Existent chooses.

KAL-063.05

They object: if everything required for the world existed in eternity, the world itself must have existed; but if the world depends on a new event, the same question passes to that event, producing an infinite regress.

KAL-063.06

We reply that one of the necessary conditions may be will, whose function is to prefer and specify whichever time the agent chooses.

KAL-063.07

As for the argument for the pre-eternity of matter and time on the ground that their origination would imply an infinite regress of materials and times, this is weak.

KAL-063.08

Chapter. The philosophers say that a body composed of bodies of different natures is composite; otherwise it is simple.

KAL-063.09

The simple body is either celestial or elemental; a composite body is either thoroughly mixed or not.

KAL-063.10

The celestial body at the outermost boundary is called the determiner of directions. It is argued that real directions, such as up and down, must be fixed by a single spherical body surrounding the whole.

KAL-063.11

Its near direction is determined by its circumference and its remote direction by its centre.

Cairo 1912 printed page 64

KAL-064.01

Its corporeality follows because it must have position. Its unity follows because if several bodies were posited and some encompassed others, the encompassing one would be the determiner.

KAL-064.02

Otherwise, only the nearer direction would be determined. Moreover, the fact that each of the two would lie in a direction relative to the other would require an antecedent determiner.

KAL-064.03

As for sphericity: what is not spherical cannot serve to determine the remote direction. Composition or departure from roundness would already presuppose direction, since that happens through rectilinear motion.

KAL-064.04

As for encompassing: a non-encompassing body defines only the nearer direction. There must be enclosure of the whole, for if what is enclosed admits an indication extending beyond it, it cannot be the final terminus.

KAL-064.05

They suppose that this determiner is the ninth of the celestial spheres said to have been demonstrated, and that it moves from east to west about a circle called the celestial equator and two poles known as the poles of the world.

KAL-064.06

Beneath it are the sphere of the fixed stars, then Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, the Sun, Venus, and Mercury, followed by—[continued on p.65].

Cairo 1912 printed page 65

KAL-065.01

—then the Moon. The circle of motion of the eighth sphere is called the zodiacal belt; it intersects the [equatorial] circle at two points, known as the vernal and autumnal equinoctial points.

KAL-065.02

Between them lie the summer and winter solstitial points.

KAL-065.03

By supposing six circles intersecting at the zodiacal poles, the celestial sphere is divided into twelve divisions, each called a zodiacal sign.

KAL-065.04

The details belong to astronomy (ʿilm al-hayʾa).

KAL-065.05

According to us, the void is possible, and motion depends upon a freely choosing agent.

KAL-065.06

Rectilinear motions, through which division and reunion would occur, are possible for the celestial sphere.

KAL-065.07

The heavenly bodies swim in their spheres in the manner known to God.

KAL-065.08

They say that beneath the sphere of the Moon lies the element fire, hot, dry, and transparent.

KAL-065.09

Then comes air, hot, moist, and transparent; then water, cold, moist, and transparent; then earth, cold and dry.

KAL-065.10

Each changes into the element adjacent to it: this is generation and corruption.

KAL-065.11

It belongs to divine providence that some of the earth is uncovered and provides the means of life for animals.

KAL-065.12

Fire has one layer, while each of the remaining elements has several.

KAL-065.13

Rising vapour may reach the freezing layer of the air and condense—[continued on p. 66].

Cairo 1912 printed page 66

KAL-066.01

—as cloud, descending as rain, snow, or hail. If it does not reach that layer, it becomes fog or falls as frost or dew.

KAL-066.02

Smoke may rise with the vapour and become enclosed in clouds, producing through tearing and collision the sound of thunder and a delicate fire called lightning, or a dense one called the thunderbolt.

KAL-066.03

Rising exhalations may condense through cold and descend by agitating the air; this is cold wind.

KAL-066.04

The awe-inspiring occurrences associated with winds testify that they come from none but the Sender of winds.

KAL-066.05

When abundant viscous clay hardens under great heat, it becomes stone; when some of it is hollowed out by various causes, mountains form.

KAL-066.06

Because they receive little warmth from reflected rays, snow and moisture remain upon them; minerals, clouds, and springs are consequently formed [on this reported physical account].

KAL-066.07

When the earth is split by vapours and exhalations trapped within it, earthquakes result.

KAL-066.08

These may be accompanied by burning fires and tremendous sounds.

KAL-066.09

Sometimes its vapour turns into water and openings form flowing or still springs; sometimes the water must be exposed by excavation, giving wells and channels.

KAL-066.10

Chapter. When the elements, reduced to minute parts, come together and act upon one another—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 67

KAL-067.01

—their powers [interact] and the intensity of each quality is broken; an intermediate quality, similar throughout the mixture, arises and is called temperament (mizāj).

KAL-067.02

If it derives from powers equal in magnitude, it is balanced; otherwise it is unbalanced, through one quality or two nonopposing qualities, so that eight classes result.

KAL-067.03

“Balanced” is also applied when the mixture receives the appropriate share of quantities and qualities for its species, subclass, individual, or organ.

KAL-067.04

Balance can be estimated by external or internal criteria; according to most, the fourth climatic zone is the most temperate by the arrangement of the heavenly bodies.

KAL-067.05

If a mixture possesses a principle of nutrition and growth, it is an animal if it also possesses sensation and motion, but a plant if it does not; if the first principle is absent as well, it is mineral.

KAL-067.06

Mineral substance is either fusible together with malleability, as in the seven metals; or [fusible] together with—[the next page continues].

Cairo 1912 printed page 68

KAL-068.01

—combustible, as sulphur is, or neither, as glass is; or it is non-fusible through excessive moisture, as mercury, or dryness, as ruby.

KAL-068.02

Plants share with animals a need for natural faculties, including the nutritive faculty, which transforms food into the likeness of the nourished body.

KAL-068.03

It is served by the attractive, retentive, digestive, and expulsive faculties.

KAL-068.04

Digestion proceeds first in the stomach, beginning in the mouth, and then in the liver, blood vessels, and organs.

KAL-068.05

Another faculty is growth: it introduces nourishment into the bodily parts, increasing their dimensions in a natural proportion.

KAL-068.06

Another is the reproductive faculty: from food it produces material fit to begin another individual, differentiates it into various parts, and imparts the appropriate configurations.

KAL-068.07

This latter activity is sometimes attributed to another faculty, called the formative faculty.

KAL-068.08

They then became divided over whether these faculties are multiple in their own essences or merely through distinct aspects (ḥaythiyyāt), and over what exactly unifies, preserves and governs the parts until the individual is fully constituted.

KAL-068.09

They are perplexed as to the manner in which such well-ordered actions and forms arise —[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 69

KAL-069.01

—the extraordinary forms and unusual shapes observable among plant species from natural faculties, ultimately taking refuge in the explanation provided by the powerful Creator.

KAL-069.02

Animals possess psychic faculties of apprehension and motion.

KAL-069.03

The apprehensive faculties are the external and internal senses.

KAL-069.04

Among the external senses is touch, a power diffused throughout the body by which heat, cold, and similar qualities are perceived.

KAL-069.05

Taste is a power distributed in the nerves spread over the tongue, through which flavours are apprehended.

KAL-069.06

Smell is a power in the two projections at the front of the brain by which odours are known through the arrival of air, not by the separation of particles from odorous objects.

KAL-069.07

Hearing is a power in a nerve of the inner auditory passage, by which sounds are apprehended through the arrival of air.

KAL-069.08

Sight is a power located at the meeting of two hollow nerves branching toward the eyes, by which colours and lights are perceived.

KAL-069.09

This occurs either by imprinting [of a form] or by the emission of a ray; each view has indications in its favour.

KAL-069.10

The indications for the first theory include the necessity of light in the eye and the necessity of the likeness being imprinted in the facing receptive subject.

KAL-069.11

Other senses are affected by the sensible object coming to them, and an image of the sun can remain for a time in the eyes of one who gazed at it and then looked away.

KAL-069.12

For the second [theory], visual perception varies with the ray; light is reportedly seen leaving the eye in darkness, and rays are perceived when one closes one’s eyes while looking at a lamp—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 70

KAL-070.01

For us, sight occurs solely through God’s creation [of vision].

KAL-070.02

It is not accepted that seeing additionally requires, after the soundness of the organ, attention, and the presence of the visible object, that the object be dense, luminous, opposite the viewer or equivalent to it, and that there be no intervening veil, excessive closeness or distance, diminutiveness, or error.

KAL-070.03

The claim that vision necessarily ensues whenever these conditions are fulfilled is likewise rejected.

KAL-070.04

Among the internal faculties is the common sense: the power in which forms of the sensible objects converge as they are conveyed along the paths of the senses.

KAL-070.05

Evidence includes judging one sensible feature by another, and the sleeper’s or sick person’s perception of what has no external presence.

KAL-070.06

It also explains perceiving a falling drop as a straight line and a moving flame as a circle.

KAL-070.07

Imagination (khayāl) preserves sensory forms: they leave the common sense without being wholly lost as in forgetting, since they can readily be recalled.

KAL-070.08

Estimation (wahm) is the faculty for perceiving particular intentions; retention preserves the judgments of estimation.

KAL-070.09

The combinative faculty manipulates forms and intentions: when intellect uses it, it is called the cogitative faculty; when estimation uses it, the imaginative faculty.

KAL-070.10

Common sense is assigned to the front of the brain’s first ventricle, imagination to its rear, the combinative faculty to the middle ventricle, estimation to the front of the last ventricle, and retention to its rear; the evidence offered is that disturbance of a faculty accompanies disturbance of its assigned locus.

KAL-070.11

Among the moving faculties, one is desiderative: it impels [an animal] towards— [completed on printed p.71].

Cairo 1912 printed page 71

KAL-071.01

—seeking benefit or warding off harm. The former is called the appetitive faculty, and the latter the irascible faculty.

KAL-071.02

Another is an effective power that tightens nerves toward their origin, as in contraction, or away from it, as in extension.

KAL-071.03

Discourse on immaterial things, comprising two inquiries.

KAL-071.04

The first concerns the soul, which they divide into celestial and human.

KAL-071.05

The word soul may also designate the source of the operations of plants or animals, in which cases it is called vegetative or animal.

KAL-071.06

The approved theological view is that the human soul is a subtle body diffused through the organism, which does not alter or dissolve, or that it is the fundamental parts without which life cannot subsist.

KAL-071.07

The philosophers and certain theologians hold that it is an immaterial substance directing the body through its orientation toward it.

KAL-071.08

First: we make judgments about particulars, while what apprehends a particular in us, they contend, is nothing but a body.

KAL-071.09

A second is that what “I” refers to—the soul—is described by bodily properties.

KAL-071.10

Third, an immaterial entity would stand in the same relation to all bodies, so transfer would be possible and one could not be certain that Zayd now is the same person as before.

KAL-071.11

Fourth, the outward tenor of scriptural texts is appealed to. Proponents of the immaterial soul argue, first, that in knowing intelligibles the soul receives what is neither material nor possessed of spatial position or magnitude—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 72

KAL-072.01

—nor is it susceptible of division.

KAL-072.02

Second, the soul knows itself, its instruments, and its own cognition; it is not weakened by a multiplicity of acts or by bodily weakening, whereas no bodily power is like this.

KAL-072.03

Third, if the rational faculty were in a body, then either the object’s mere presence suffices for intellection, in which case it would never cease to be apprehended, or it does not, in which case intellection cannot occur without positing incompatible duplications of a single form.

KAL-072.04

Souls are then said to be alike because their definition is one; another view holds they differ because their necessary concomitants differ.

KAL-072.05

They agree that souls endure without end; this is sometimes used to infer their pre-eternity, together with their alleged independence of a locus.

KAL-072.06

Their origination is supported by the objection that, if souls existed before bodies, they would be idle, unlike after separation when they remain occupied.

KAL-072.07

Moreover, if souls had not come into being, their plurality would be impossible. If they were nonetheless plural, distinguishing them by their quiddities or essential concomitants would conflict with their being of one kind; distinguishing them by what inheres in them, such as consciousness of their own identities, would entail circularity.

KAL-072.08

Distinguishing souls by bodily accidents would require a prior body before every body, implying—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 73

KAL-073.01

—transmigration and the eternity of body; and souls would stand on an equal footing toward all bodies.

KAL-073.02

If one soul had previously been associated with another body, it should remember some of that body’s circumstances.

KAL-073.03

Two souls would then coexist [in one body], for the body’s complete temperament would cause a new soul to arise by the universality of emanation.

KAL-073.04

Transmigrationists ultimately claim that no soul remains idle and that souls are naturally directed toward perfection.

KAL-073.05

What revelation establishes concerning transformation and resurrection is not transmigration.

KAL-073.06

As for the account according to which perfected souls join the world of intellects, intermediate ones attach to celestial bodies or imaginal forms, and deficient ones inhabit animals corresponding to their acquired habits—

KAL-073.07

—progressively becoming established in such configurations until they are freed from darkness, it is merely a reported story.

KAL-073.08

What is established by revelation is the soul’s continuance.

KAL-073.09

The philosophers agree, arguing that the soul depends upon the eternal cause either independently or with an originated condition at its coming to be, but not for its continued existence.

KAL-073.10

Moreover, the potency for annihilation—meaning a dispositional possibility of ceasing to exist—would require a substrate.

KAL-073.11

Chapter. On our view, the soul apprehends particulars because it judges concerning them and possesses hearing and sight.

KAL-073.12

According to the philosophers, the senses do so, since it is evident that—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 74

KAL-074.01

—vision belongs to the organ of sight and damage to it damages vision; much also resists being imprinted in an immaterial subject.

KAL-074.02

The claim that the soul does not apprehend particulars in itself but only through bodily instruments would remove the disagreement; however, it entails that apprehension of particulars would not persist after the loss of those instruments, whereas revelation indicates the contrary.

KAL-074.03

Chapter. The soul’s power, considered as receiving perfection from a higher principle, is called theoretical intellect and has four grades.

KAL-074.04

The material (hylic) intellect, characterized by pure preparedness.

KAL-074.05

Intellect in habit, prepared for theoretical propositions through possession of necessary first principles.

KAL-074.06

Intellect in actuality, able to bring theoretical cognitions to mind without needing to acquire them afresh.

KAL-074.07

Acquired intellect, in which the theoretical intelligibles are present in actual contemplation.

KAL-074.08

Considered as exercising influence upon the body for its perfection, the soul’s power is called practical intellect: the capacity to infer and act so as to regulate worldly life and the life to come.

KAL-074.09

From the former proceeds theoretical wisdom, defined as knowing things as they are to the measure of human capacity.

KAL-074.10

From the latter proceeds practical wisdom, defined as undertaking actions as they ought to be performed within the same human capacity.

KAL-074.11

For this reason it is said that jurisprudence (fiqh)—[continued on the following page].

Cairo 1912 printed page 75

KAL-075.01

[Fiqh is] a name for knowledge and action together. Practical wisdom is also sometimes said to mean knowledge of what concerns our voluntary choices.

KAL-075.02

If it concerns the improvement of an individual, it is refinement of character; of a household, household management; and of the inhabitants of a city, political governance.

KAL-075.03

The foundations of virtuous character are moderation of the appetitive faculty, which is temperance; the irascible faculty, which is courage; and the rational faculty, which is wisdom. Taken together, they constitute justice.

KAL-075.04

Each virtue has two vicious extremes, excess and deficiency: for temperance, insensibility and wantonness; for courage, rashness and cowardice; for wisdom, unscrupulous cleverness and stupidity.

KAL-075.05

Second investigation: concerning intellect.

KAL-075.06

They argue for its existence thus: the first created thing cannot be a body, because a body is composite; nor prime matter or form, because one would have to be an efficient cause of the other; nor an accident, for it depends on something besides its efficient cause; nor a soul, for it cannot subsist independently owing to its union with what comes after it.

KAL-075.07

The cause of the first bodies must involve some multiplicity, lest many effects proceed directly from the one; yet it must be independent of corporeality in both its essence and its action, lest a thing be prior to itself.

KAL-075.08

They say the ceaseless movement of the spheres aims at attaining an abiding likeness which nevertheless is not stably possessed; an intellect perfect in act has perfections that do not come to an end.

KAL-075.09

Otherwise either the movement would cease or an impossibility would be sought.

Cairo 1912 printed page 76

KAL-076.01

It is not the Necessary Existent, for then the motions would not differ; therefore [they say] an intellect is required.

KAL-076.02

The intellects are substances abstracted from matter both in their essences and in all their acts.

KAL-076.03

They claim that there are at least ten, the tenth being the governor of the world of elements.

KAL-076.04

They claim that these are eternal; that each species is confined to its individual, which possesses its perfections, understands itself, the other immaterial beings, and all universals.

KAL-076.05

They regard the intellects as sources of perfection for souls and bodies. From the first [intellect], insofar as it has existence, another intellect proceeds; insofar as it is necessary through another, a soul; and insofar as it is possible, a body.

KAL-076.06

They claim that the angels are the immaterial intellects and the celestial souls.

KAL-076.07

They claim that the jinn are immaterial spirits exercising influence upon elemental bodies and that the devils are imaginative powers.

KAL-076.08

They hold that each sphere has a universal soul, from which numerous souls branch off, and that the soul directing the Throne is called the Universal Soul.

KAL-076.09

They further posit, for each kind of generated being, a spirit governing its affairs; this they call the “perfect nature” (al-ṭibāʿ al-tāmm).

KAL-076.10

According to us, angels are subtle bodies that assume different forms, characterized by goodness, obedience, and the capacity for arduous tasks.

Cairo 1912 printed page 77

KAL-077.01

The jinn are likewise [subtle bodies], except that among them are the obedient and the disobedient; devils are marked by evil and seduction.

KAL-077.02

There is nothing to preclude their appearing to some observers under some circumstances.

KAL-077.03

We have omitted many further discussions belonging to each topic for fear of excessive prolixity. God guides to the right path.

KAL-077.04

Fifth chapter: theological matters, consisting of sections.

KAL-077.05

First section: on the divine essence.

KAL-077.06

Possible beings require a Necessary Being, and originated beings an eternal one, to exclude causal circularity and infinite regress.

KAL-077.07

Divine scripture frequently directs attention to the horizons and the self—their entities and qualities—as evidence through their possibility and origination.

KAL-077.08

This approach is evident to everyone and beneficial to the general public; multiplying such reflections can lead to certainty.

KAL-077.09

Reflection upon these things leads to the conclusion that the maker of such things cannot be other than absolutely self-sufficient, endowed with attributes of perfection and exalted above passing away.

KAL-077.10

The truth is that the essence of the Necessary Being is unlike every other essence; otherwise the possible would have to be necessary or the Necessary would be possible. That He is beginningless and endless needs no elaboration.

KAL-077.11

Section: on affirming God’s transcendence.

KAL-077.12

The Necessary in itself has no part—for otherwise it would be possible—and cannot have multiple individual instances.

Cairo 1912 printed page 78

KAL-078.01

For that by which alleged instances differ must be identical with necessary essence, a part of it, or something entailed by it—in which case multiplicity disappears—or else extrinsic, in which case necessity is lost.

KAL-078.02

If two necessary beings were posited, the effect intended by both would either occur through both together, denying independent efficacy; or through each separately, bringing two causes to bear upon one effect; or through only one of them, making one prevail without a determinant.

KAL-078.03

If one could not bring about the contrary of what the other intended, it would be powerless. If it could, the occurrence of both contraries together would be impossible; otherwise one or both would be powerless, or both motion and rest would be excluded, or one alternative preferred without a preferrer.

KAL-078.04

Furthermore, if the two agreed on every possible object, their causes would coincide in producing a single effect; otherwise there would be mutual obstruction. Many texts point to this, including “Had there been in them gods other than God, they would have been corrupted.”

KAL-078.05

Those who associate partners with God are—[the list follows on p. 79].

Cairo 1912 printed page 79

KAL-079.01

—the dualists who affirm light and darkness; the Magians [who affirm] Ahriman and Yazdān; those who attribute offspring [to God]; and worshippers of idols and celestial bodies. For worthiness to be worshipped entails necessary existence.

KAL-079.02

Those who affirm eternal divine attributes, human creation of human acts, the devil’s responsibility for evil, or intellects as causes of souls, certain bodies and sublunary phenomena may nevertheless regard themselves as safeguarding divine unity.

KAL-079.03

Nonetheless, affirming a plurality of eternally existing independent essences is a grave matter.

KAL-079.04

The Necessary Being is not a body or accident, because of dependence; nor spatially confined, since this would entail the pre-eternity—indeed, the necessity—of spatial locus and the possibility of the Necessary Being: what is spatially confined needs a locus, not conversely. Nor is He a substance in the relevant technical sense, since it admits possibility.

KAL-079.05

Even if “substance” were intended simply to mean what subsists in itself, and “body” what exists, these expressions are prohibited on scriptural grounds and as a precaution.

KAL-079.06

The claim that God is a body in human or another form, situated above, touching the Throne or facing it—based on the assumption that every existent must be a body or embodied, spatially confined, inhering, connected to the world or detached from it—is ignorance.

KAL-079.07

The scriptural expressions in question receive appropriate interpretation.

KAL-079.08

Nor does He undergo union (*ittiḥād*), for the foregoing reasons and because this would entail transformation or the conjunction of necessity and possibility; nor does He indwell (*ḥulūl*), since dependence and spatial location are impossible for Him.

KAL-079.09

The doctrines of indwelling and union are reported of Christians concerning Jesus, and of some extremists concerning—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 80

KAL-080.01

—ʿAlī.

KAL-080.02

He cannot be characterized by an originated attribute: this would be change; the attribute would have been absent in pre-eternity, implying an inadmissible change of condition, and the removal of its opposite would entail never being free of originated states.

KAL-080.03

As for possessing an attribute with an originated relational application, or the renewal of negations, relations, and states, that is not the point in dispute.

KAL-080.04

Section: on positive or existent attributes.

KAL-080.05

The correct view is that the attributes are additional to the essence: one understands “knowing” as possessing knowledge, and likewise in other cases. If His knowledge were simply His essence, predicating it would contribute nothing; the distinct attributes would not be distinguished and would not need independent establishment.

KAL-080.06

It is possible to predicate of Him what can be predicated of the essence.

KAL-080.07

The Muʿtazila object that this entails perfection received from another, explains His being knowing by knowledge even though this is necessary to Him, and multiplies eternal entities.

KAL-080.08

We reply: an attribute is neither simply identical [with the essence] nor wholly other; even granting the objection, it would not preclude “completion” in the sense of possessing a perfection.

KAL-080.09

What is necessary in the sense of being inseparably concomitant may be explained through what proceeds from the essence; unbelief concerns multiplying ancient essences, as in certain Christian claims.

KAL-080.10

They object that the persistence of attributes would require one meaning to subsist in another, which they deem impossible. We answer that what is impossible is one accident subsisting in another; “meaning” is broader. Even if conceded, attributes persist with the essence or their continuance is identical with them.

KAL-080.11

They object that His power is of the same kind as that of an observed agent, and so the effects of the two powers cannot differ. We deny this. [The exact subsequent explanation of the dependence of originated things upon God needs a second witness.]

Cairo 1912 printed page 81

KAL-081.01

The disappearance of what is established through necessitation does not entail the disappearance of the necessitating cause. Nor, in the argument under consideration, is it impossible to ascribe the positions of stars, the poles, and variations in configurations and shapes to a nonchoosing agent.

KAL-081.02

The discussion appeals to revealed proofs, to the fact that power and the other attributes are perfections whereas their opposites are defects, and to the order and precision of the world, which cannot be conceived except as arising from an agent with knowledge and power.

KAL-081.03

The opponent objects that the exercise of power requires a preference, giving rise to a regress; that if its determining relation is eternal the effect is eternal, whereas if originated it leads to a regress; and that an effect arises only once all conditions are complete, apparently leaving no choice.

KAL-081.04

They further object that if the chosen effect is preferable this entails acquiring perfection, otherwise acting pointlessly; and if action was impossible in pre-eternity, this implies change, whereas if it was possible an eternal thing would depend upon a free chooser.

KAL-081.05

They argue that if the act is known as existent, it is inevitable, and if known as nonexistent, it is impossible.

KAL-081.06

The response is that the determining factor is the will’s relation by its own nature, avoiding regress, and that an eternal will can relate to bringing about an effect at its appointed time.

KAL-081.07

Necessity through voluntary choice does not negate choice; an act can be preferable in itself or for another without being futile.

KAL-081.08

An originated effect can be possible in itself from eternity while not realized until the choice of the agent; its existence follows from divine power, which neither ceases nor is confined to some possibilities.

Cairo 1912 printed page 82

KAL-082.01

The ground of being powerful is the essence, while what qualifies something as an object of power is its possibility: thus God has power over all things.

KAL-082.02

Some Muʿtazilites dissent concerning evil acts, others concerning what falls within human power, and others concerning cases like these.

KAL-082.03

On our account, everything depends directly upon Him. On other accounts, the dependence may be direct or through an intermediary; for the philosophers it proceeds without choice, whether immediately or mediately.

KAL-082.04

Another attribute is knowledge, established through the world’s dependence on Him together with its precision and order, and through His being a powerful voluntary agent. Revelation likewise establishes it, as it establishes power and speech.

KAL-082.05

His knowledge is neither interrupted nor confined, for reasons analogous to those already given.

KAL-082.06

Some deny His knowledge of His own essence on the ground that knowledge requires two terms; some object to knowledge of knowledge because it would entail an infinity of attributes; others to knowing the infinite because they deem it impossible to exist; and others to knowing the nonexistent because they take it to be pure negation.

KAL-082.07

Philosophers deny [on their account] His knowledge of particulars because these change.

KAL-082.08

The reply is that some particulars do not change, and changes in a relation do not entail a change in the thing related: the eternal exists before an event, then with it, then after it.

KAL-082.09

This is the sense in which it is said that the Creator’s knowing that a thing will exist is the very same knowledge as His knowing that it has existed.

KAL-082.10

Knowledge does not change when the known object changes, nor become multiple through the multiplicity of its objects, just as a mirror reveals many images. But this account is sound only if knowledge is not made identical with the relation itself, but is a quality having a relation.

KAL-082.11

Another is the will, an attribute other than knowledge, through which one of two sides [of a possibility] is specified—[continued on p.83].

Cairo 1912 printed page 83

KAL-083.01

—of an object of power as actual. Its relation is grounded in itself, and the eternity of will does not entail the eternity of what is willed.

KAL-083.02

It is plainly false to hold that will is an originated attribute subsisting in God; likewise inadequate are definitions of will as knowledge of the best arrangement, the agent’s absence of compulsion or forgetfulness, knowledge of His own acts or command concerning another’s, or a motive toward an act understood as knowledge of some additional benefit.

KAL-083.03

Scriptural texts establish will, and its connection with voluntary action does not negate choice.

KAL-083.04

Other attributes are life, hearing and sight, established by decisive scriptural passages and the consensus of the prophets—indeed, of rational people generally.

KAL-083.05

Lacking them would be a defect. Hence these three attributes are affirmed as eternal; it does not follow that things heard and seen are themselves eternal.

KAL-083.06

The suggestion that they are merely a balance of bodily temperament, a sensory impression, or abstract knowledge of things heard and seen is rejected.

KAL-083.07

As for smelling, tasting and touching, revelation has not affirmed them as divine attributes, nor has reason allowed them as such; nevertheless, the adopted position is that God apprehends their respective objects.

KAL-083.08

Another attribute is speech, affirmed by the testimony of the prophets, without making the probative force of a miracle circularly depend on it. Its opposite would be an imperfection in a living being; it is an eternal attribute opposed to silence and incapacity, signified by spoken expression and writing.

KAL-083.09

Most theological groups take sensible speech, rather than inward speech, to be what “speech” means. Only the Ḥanbalites and those termed ḥashwiyya maintain its eternity, and the falsity of that [claim concerning sensible speech] is held to be evident.

Cairo 1912 printed page 84

KAL-084.01

Because [audible speech] consists of ordered parts and does not persist, the Muʿtazilites hold that it is originated in a body: God’s speaking it means that He creates it therein.

KAL-084.02

Our argument is that a speaker is one in whom speech subsists; since verbal speech cannot subsist in God, internal or meaningful speech is intended.

KAL-084.03

The claim that ordered discourse can exist all at once, as in the mind of one who memorizes it or in a stamp, is an illusion.

KAL-084.04

Further, everyone who commands, forbids, or reports finds within himself a meaning other than knowledge or will, which he signifies by utterance and writing.

KAL-084.05

It is common among speakers of the language to call this “speech”; there is no dispute that the term also applies, by equivocation or common figurative usage, to the particular audible arrangement.

KAL-084.06

The audible arrangement is not merely an indicator of His eternal speech; He brings it forth as writing on the Preserved Tablet or as articulated letters by an angel. Its Arabic form alone is named the Qurʾān in common usage.

KAL-084.07

In legal theory, the proofs of the occurrence of the recited or transmitted wording—its being sent down, recited, heard, and used in the challenge—refer to this sense.

KAL-084.08

They object: reporting past events in pre-eternity would be false, while commanding and forbidding then would be foolish and pointless.

KAL-084.09

It is answered that speech becomes one of these divisions in temporal application (*fīmā lā yazāl*), and it suffices that an addressee be conceivable.

KAL-084.10

More precisely, it is a request addressed to someone who will come into existence. The adopted position holds that speech is one in pre-eternity, becoming multiple by its relational applications.

Cairo 1912 printed page 85

KAL-085.01

For revelation has not established a multiplicity [of the eternal speech itself].

KAL-085.02

Shaykh al-Ashʿarī affirmed subsistence as an attribute, arguing that a thing that abides without an attribute of abiding would resemble something called knowing without knowledge.

KAL-085.03

The response is that subsistence means the continuation of existence; moreover, the same question would recur concerning the subsistence of subsistence.

KAL-085.04

Some jurists affirm bringing-into-being (takwīn) as an attribute: God is Creator by consensus and praises Himself as such in eternal speech, so they argue that creation must be an eternal attribute.

KAL-085.05

They explain this by the common statement that He brings things into existence at their appointed times through the eternal command “Be”; the eternity of this attribute no more entails the eternity of what is produced than eternal knowledge entails the eternity of its object.

KAL-085.06

The correct view is that creating is a relational meaning, understood through the connection of agent and effect, and is nothing beyond the relation of power and will. Praising God as Creator in pre-eternity is comparable to praising Him on the basis that “what is in the heavens and what is on earth glorifies Him”: that is, He is such that this is attributable to Him when its time comes.

KAL-085.07

When it is said that “creating is the created thing,” this means that what is conceived through “creation” is the product, and what results from producing is simply the effect.

KAL-085.08

Other divine descriptions ultimately refer back to the attributes mentioned: expressions such as sitting upon the Throne, hand, face, and eye are figures and analogical expressions.

KAL-085.09

Section: concerning His states and what may be predicated of Him.

KAL-085.10

The correct view is that God may be seen, meaning that the perceptual state experienced when looking at the moon may occur [regarding Him], without spatial direction or— [continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 86

KAL-086.01

—confrontation, and that this will occur for believers in Paradise.

KAL-086.02

As to its possibility: Moses, peace be upon him, asked for the vision, and God made it conditional upon something possible in itself, the mountain’s remaining in place.

KAL-086.03

The suggestions that Moses merely requested necessary knowledge, that he requested the vision for his people, or that he sought added reassurance are plainly implausible in view of his having already heard the divine speech.

KAL-086.04

One argument maintains that the common object of sight shared by substance and accident is existence itself, which they share with the Necessary Being.

KAL-086.05

This follows from the previous point: origination and possibility are nonpositive, while nonexistent things share in them. Once something exists that can qualify as a thing seen, the possibility of vision is self-evident.

KAL-086.06

This argument would permit seeing anything that exists, even tastes, smells and cognitions, however implausible that sounds.

KAL-086.07

If it is said that one specific kind may have different explanatory grounds, we reply that the issue is what vision has as its object: one may see something without perceiving that it is a substance or an accident, much less its specific nature.

KAL-086.08

As for its actual occurrence, God says, “Faces on that day will be radiant, looking toward their Lord,” and “looking toward” in this construction is not ordinarily employed except for vision.

KAL-086.09

Interpreting “looking” as waiting, and “toward” as referring to a blessing, is forced.

KAL-086.10

Other evidence includes “No indeed! On that day they shall be veiled from their Lord,” and “For those who do good is the good reward, and an increase.”

Cairo 1912 printed page 87

KAL-087.01

And the Prophet, upon him be blessings and peace, said: “You will see your Lord as you see this full moon.”

KAL-087.02

Another proof speaks of looking toward the face of God. The opponent claims that vision requires spatial opposition and depends upon the usual conditions of sight; both assertions are denied.

KAL-087.03

The central opposing text is “Eyes do not comprehend Him, but He comprehends eyes,” allegedly excluding every instance of sight.

KAL-087.04

The reply denies that “comprehending” is synonymous with seeing; even if it encompasses vision, the negation does not necessarily extend to all persons and all times.

KAL-087.05

As for “You shall not see Me,” the particle does not itself imply exclusion forever or across all times.

KAL-087.06

As for their regarding the request for vision as momentous, that was due to their weakness.

KAL-087.07

Conclusion: The truth is that nothing is known of God Most High except [His] existence, attributes, negations, and relations.

Cairo 1912 printed page 88

KAL-088.01

Section: on divine acts.

KAL-088.02

God is the originator of the servant’s act; the servant has acquisition (kasb), which is a relational matter pertaining to the servant. It does not itself bring the possible act into existence but qualifies the agent through it.

KAL-088.03

That is, specifying one of the two alternatives, preferring it, and directing one’s power toward it.

KAL-088.04

According to the Muʿtazila the servant brings the act into existence; they even apply “creator” to him, which would make every animal a creator.

KAL-088.05

God says, “God is Creator of everything”; “He created everything”; “We have created everything according to a measure”; and “God created you and what you do.”

KAL-088.06

Likewise, “He is God, the Creator”; “Doer of whatsoever He wills”; “All is from God”; “He inscribed faith upon their hearts”; and “He it is Who makes people laugh and weep.”

KAL-088.07

Numerous prophetic reports convey that every occurrence is through God’s power and will.

KAL-088.08

Were the servant’s action produced by his own power [as an independent efficient cause], this would bring two efficient causes together, since God’s power encompasses every effect and He knows its details.

KAL-088.09

He would supposedly be able to refrain while a determinant beyond him favors the act, yet the act must occur when its complete conditions obtain and God already knows that it occurs.

KAL-088.10

Another argument holds that if a servant could independently bring about an act he could reproduce it, produce one like it, or create bodies; yet the creation of faith would be better than the production of—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 89

KAL-089.01

—the Creator’s producing Satan; nor [under the hypothesis of the servant’s independent creation] would it be fitting to ask [God] for help with the act or to thank [Him] for it.

KAL-089.02

Among the Muʿtazila, some claim the distinction is immediately evident: everyone distinguishes the motion of falling from that of rising, and finds within himself that [the latter] accords with his motives and intentions.

KAL-089.03

He is convinced that what he annuls, prohibits, desires, or finds astonishing is genuinely the action of its agent.

KAL-089.04

The reply is that this does not show the servant to be its efficient creator; the act is related to the servant’s power and will and occurs in keeping with his intention and motives.

KAL-089.05

Others argue that, unless the servant acted independently, praise and blame, commands and prohibitions, reward and punishment, and the purposes of promise and threat would be void.

KAL-089.06

They also contend that some human acts are evil—such as injustice, wrongdoing and sins—which the Wise One could not create.

KAL-089.07

They further argue that the position would attribute to the Creator descriptions unbefitting Him, such as “unbeliever,” “wrongdoer,” “eater” or “sitter.”

KAL-089.08

The response is that acquisition and the related exercise of power and will suffice; the necessity or impossibility following from the complete determinant need not abolish responsibility, even when that determinant is considered in relation to eternal knowledge.

KAL-089.09

Producing evil acts is not itself the evil act in the same sense as performing them; consider that God creates the devil, the source of many evils.

KAL-089.10

The doer of an act is the one in whom the act occurs, not necessarily the one who brings it into being in another subject.

KAL-089.11

As scriptural evidence, [they invoke] the verses attributing—[continued on p. 90].

Cairo 1912 printed page 90

KAL-090.01

—actions to human beings, especially language suggesting production, such as “Whoever works righteousness,” “Whatever good you do,” and “Blessed be God, the best of creators.”

KAL-090.02

They also cite passages that God does not prevent faith and obedience, nor force people into disbelief and disobedience, such as “What prevented the people from believing?” and “How can you disbelieve?”

KAL-090.03

Other texts connect human acts to human choice: “Act as you will” and “Let whoever wishes believe.”

KAL-090.04

The response is that some texts are not in dispute; others are interpreted in light of the whole body of evidence. Human willing occurs only within divine willing: “You do not will unless God wills.”

KAL-090.05

The adopted position rejects both compulsion and absolute delegation: immediate principles of action involve choice, while remote principles involve necessity; thus a human acts in the form of voluntary choice while still dependent upon divine determination.

KAL-090.06

God’s decree and determination mean His creating and measuring, immediately or through intermediaries. Acceptance is due to the decree as divine act, not to every thing decreed. For the Muʿtazilites, the expression is admissible only in the senses of making known or clarifying, recording upon the Tablet, or imposing duties.

KAL-090.07

There is no dispute, he says, over criticism of the Qadariyya, so named because of their zeal in rejecting predestination; the suggestion that the affirmers of predestination deserve that label more is rejected.

KAL-090.08

He cites the report, “The Qadariyya are the Magians of this community,” and another prophetic report beginning, “When the Resurrection comes …” [continued on p. 91].

Cairo 1912 printed page 91

KAL-091.01

“… a herald proclaims: ‘God’s adversaries on the Day of Resurrection are the Qadariyya.’” He adds that those who attribute determination to themselves more properly deserve the name.

KAL-091.02

Texts establishing that everything occurs by God’s will are too numerous to count, to the point that the saying “What God wills comes to pass, and what He does not will does not” has become proverbial. How could it be otherwise when He is the creator and willer of everything?

KAL-091.03

Since God knows that what does not occur will not occur, how could He will it? This is the reported objection that motivates the following discussion.

KAL-091.04

The Muʿtazila maintain that God does not will wicked acts but their opposites, even if these do not occur; this implies that much occurring within His dominion runs contrary to His will.

KAL-091.05

They argue that willing evil is itself evil, that punishing what God wills would be unjust, that commanding what is not willed and forbidding what is willed would be futile, and that willing something entails commanding, approving, and loving it. The author rejects each inference.

KAL-091.06

As for the divine response to those who say, “If God had wished, we would not have associated partners,” it rebukes their mockery or their use of predestination as an excuse, not simply the statement of divine omnipotence.

Cairo 1912 printed page 92

KAL-092.01

He also says, “Had He willed, He would have guided you all.” As to the verse “The evil of all that is hateful before your Lord,” the objectionable act is described as disliked by people and in ordinary customary judgments.

KAL-092.02

Section.

KAL-092.03

Goodness and badness, in the sense of deserving praise and blame, reward and punishment, are determined in God’s judgment by revelation.

KAL-092.04

He cites “We do not punish until We send a messenger”; were moral liability intrinsic to an act it would never be absent from that act, and the servant does not independently produce the act.

KAL-092.05

Rationally assigning ultimate praise and blame would require the independent production of an act, which he denies.

KAL-092.06

The Muʿtazila hold instead that reason determines goodness and badness, because the goodness of beneficence and evil of aggression are self-evident.

KAL-092.07

They argue that, other conditions equal, reason prefers truthfulness and rescuing a drowning person to lying and causing his death; if granting miracles to a liar were not wrong, prophecy could not be established.

KAL-092.08

The response denies that the first two intuitions prove moral value in the precise disputed sense, and explains the third by appeal to the established regularity of divine custom rather than an independent obligation imposed upon God.

KAL-092.09

The Muʿtazila further argue that someone who knows God and His attributes, then associates partners with Him and ascribes imperfections to Him, certainly knows himself to deserve punishment.

KAL-092.10

We deny that this is known categorically unless it is learned from the establishment of revealed law. The subsequent objection—that, if it rested on law, instruction by the prophets would be required—continues onto p. 93, where its answer is said to have preceded.

Cairo 1912 printed page 93

KAL-093.01

—the prophets; its answer was given earlier.

KAL-093.02

Section.

KAL-093.03

There is no disagreement about the impossibility of obliging something intrinsically impossible, such as combining contradictories; nor about commands concerning things known or foretold not to occur.

KAL-093.04

The dispute concerns what is possible in itself but not within the servant’s power at all—such as creating a body (outside the servant’s power altogether) or ascending to heaven (impossible under ordinary conditions).

KAL-093.05

On our view such obligation is conceptually permissible, since reason does not independently determine its evil; but it does not actually occur, because God says, “God does not burden a soul beyond its capacity.”

KAL-093.06

According to Muʿtazilites and Shiʿites it is impermissible, being foolish and pointless.

KAL-093.07

One argument says that commanding Abū Lahab to believe everything the Prophet brought—including the report that he would never believe—would require affirming contradictories.

KAL-093.08

The response distinguishes the command to attain faith, an intrinsically possible object, from the divine foreknowledge or report that it will not in fact occur.

KAL-093.09

Section.

KAL-093.10

The correct view is that some divine acts are explained by purposes, as Scripture and consensus attest and as analogical reasoning presupposes.

KAL-093.11

The controversy is best understood as concerning whether purposiveness is universally necessary, not whether purposes are ever mentioned; the argument requires an eventual termination in an act that is not performed for a further purpose, as explained on p. 94.

Cairo 1912 printed page 94

KAL-094.01

—to some act not performed for any further end, lest an infinite regress result; they add that no benefit to anyone is apparent in the perpetual punishment of unbelievers.

KAL-094.02

The Muʿtazila hold that the purpose of imposing obligations is to allow someone to earn reward, citing “Whoever obeys God and His Messenger, He shall admit him into gardens.”

KAL-094.03

They argue that causing injury without desert or benefit is injustice, so making reward attainable is what justifies obligation.

KAL-094.04

The reply is that encouragement may be purely God’s generosity, and that, as absolute owner, He commits no injustice in the sense claimed.

KAL-094.05

Even if divine action required purposes, these could include testing, gratitude, the preservation of order, or other ends.

KAL-094.06

In brief, a limited effort cannot by itself establish desert of everlasting felicity, nor could a single draught of wine by itself establish desert of perpetual punishment.

KAL-094.07

Section.

KAL-094.08

Scripture and prophetic tradition attribute guidance, leading astray, sealing, and stamping unbelievers’ hearts to God.

KAL-094.09

For us these expressions mean that He creates guidance and error, being the sole creator.

KAL-094.10

For the Muʿtazila, guidance denotes an indication leading to benefit or an exposition by establishing proofs, for them, misguidance can mean the withholding of gracious assistance because God knows it would not prove effective; some such attributions are treated as figurative.

KAL-094.11

As for divine gentleness, enabling success, and preservation from sin, our account relates them to the creation of the capacity for obedience, while forsaking relates to the creation of a capacity—[continued on p95].

Cairo 1912 printed page 95

KAL-095.01

—sin. It has also been said that protection from sin (*ʿiṣma*) consists in God’s not creating sin in the servant; another account calls it a special characteristic with which the occurrence of sin becomes impossible.

KAL-095.02

According to the Muʿtazila, gracious assistance (*luṭf*) is what leads a morally responsible person to choose obedience—or brings him closer to it—while retaining capacity in either case.

KAL-095.03

The two kinds are called the securing kind (*al-muḥaṣṣil*) and the approximating kind (*al-muqarrib*). Divine enabling (*tawfīq*) is grace that secures performance of the required act; abandonment (*khidhlān*) is the withholding of grace; and protection from sin (*ʿiṣma*) is grace that secures abstention from the reprehensible act.

KAL-095.04

Section.

KAL-095.05

An appointed term (*ajal*) is the time at which God knows an animal’s life will cease; for each it is one.

KAL-095.06

Someone killed dies at their appointed term. Nevertheless, that death is something God creates following the servant’s act; the killer incurs liability for what he has acquired by acting and for the prohibition he has transgressed.

KAL-095.07

The “increase of lifespan” through righteousness is interpreted as an increase in blessedness or goodness, in keeping with decisive texts that the appointed term is neither advanced nor postponed.

KAL-095.08

Section.

KAL-095.09

Provision (*rizq*) is what God conveys to a living being so that it benefits from it. Each receives its provision, and no one eats another’s provision; another formulation defines it by what is meant to benefit the recipient.

KAL-095.10

Provision may be restricted to what is eaten. The Muʿtazila stipulate that no one may have the right to prevent the recipient from taking it, thereby excluding illicit consumption. On this definition, someone supported throughout life solely by illicit food or earnings would not count as being provided for—[completed on p. 96].

Cairo 1912 printed page 96

KAL-096.01

—as a person receiving provision at all. Yet revealed texts establish God’s guarantee of provisions.

KAL-096.02

Conclusion: price regulation is fixing the price at which goods are sold; prices rise and fall through causes ultimately from God, so He alone is the true determiner of prices.

KAL-096.03

Section.

KAL-096.04

The Muʿtazila impose various obligations upon God, especially divine assistance, arguing that withholding it would thwart divine purposes and facilitate wrongdoing, and that what is indispensable to an obligation must also be obligatory. They thereby face hard cases of continued unbelief and sin and the consequence that no age should be devoid of prophets and saints.

KAL-096.05

They also affirm compensatory reward for suffering, holding that to omit it would be unjust.

KAL-096.06

They differ over whether compensation is due in the hereafter, whether it is forfeited through sins, whether compensation for unbelievers, wrongdoers and nonrational beings occurs here or there, and whether animals enter Paradise; related disputes concern what is best for people in religion or worldly affairs.

KAL-096.07

They do not disagree regarding the provision of capacity and enablement, maintaining that withholding them would be miserliness or folly. We reply that, by such reasoning, God would have to refrain from creating a destitute unbeliever or keeping him in the Fire, and would neither put a virtuous person to death nor leave a wicked one unharmed —consider Iblīs and his descendants.

KAL-096.08

Section.

KAL-096.09

The distinction among a name, the thing named, and the act of naming is evident. The claim that—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 97

KAL-097.01

—the name is identical with the named, while naming differs from both, uses “name” for what it signifies. Appeals to “Glorify the name of your Lord Most High” or “To God belong the beautiful names” do not settle the dispute.

KAL-097.02

The disagreement turns on whether “name,” when used, refers to its object—as in “Zayd is a writer”—or to the uttered expression—as in “Zayd” is written.

KAL-097.03

If a predicate correctly describes God but is neither expressly authorized nor prohibited, whether it may be used as a divine name is disputed. Most refuse expressions such as “clever” or “shrewd,” which suggest deficiency, and “farmer” or “sower,” which fail to express proper majesty.

KAL-097.04

No one disputes the multiplicity of divine names considered by reference to attributes, acts, negations and relations, nor the inadmissibility of names based on a constituent part [of the divine essence].

KAL-097.05

The correct view also affirms a name referring to the essence itself—“Allah”—even though “deity” denotes one worthy of worship. His names are not limited to ninety-nine.

KAL-097.06

Chapter Six: revealed matters, comprising sections.

KAL-097.07

First section: a prophet is a human whom God sends to convey what He reveals. A messenger is sometimes defined in the same way, though “messenger” is also restricted to one bringing a law and scripture.

KAL-097.08

Sending prophets is graciousness and favor from God, embodying benefits such as enriching reason, assisting it, removing perplexities and clarifying what is obscure.

Cairo 1912 printed page 98

KAL-098.01

The one sent is recognized by signs or through evident knowledge; the benefits of religious duties outweigh their costs even when their detailed significance is hidden, as with prayer and pilgrimage.

KAL-098.02

The proof of prophecy is the miracle: an event contrary to customary order, accompanied by a challenge, without successful counterperformance.

KAL-098.03

Its evidential force is comparable to explicit confirmation: if someone claims to be the king’s messenger and says the proof is the king’s rising three times from his throne, and the king does so, certainty results.

KAL-098.04

Far-fetched possibilities—that the phenomenon has a hidden property, an astronomical cause, angelic or jinn mediation, an unfamiliar regularity, a challenge left unanswered, or an answer to prayer rather than confirmation—do not by themselves defeat its evidential force.

KAL-098.05

Such abstract possibilities do not displace ordinary certainty; the argument concerns an event whose resistance to counterperformance has been established despite intense incentive, and whose producing agent is none but God.

KAL-098.06

The evidential inference does not depend upon divine confirmation being conceived as an aim, nor on assuming at the outset the speaker’s reliability through the revelation being proved.

KAL-098.07

Section.

KAL-098.08

Muḥammad, blessings and peace upon him, is God’s messenger because he claimed the mission—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 99

KAL-099.01

—and presented a miracle: the inimitable Qurʾān in the Arabs’ own language, despite the great number of skilled and competitive Arabic speakers hostile to him; they could not refute its eloquence but sometimes attributed its power to magic.

KAL-099.02

The objections are answered in outline here, with fuller details elsewhere; the Arabs’ inability was attributed to its eloquence, not merely to divinely preventing an otherwise easy imitation.

KAL-099.03

This defeats the doctrine of ṣarfa, the claim that rivals were diverted from challenging the Qurʾān; even a reduction in rhetorical skill would be a stronger example of such diversion. Moreover, the Qurʾān reports unseen events, including narratives of Moses and Jesus and scriptural predictions of spoils, Roman fortunes, military defeat, entry into the sacred mosque and religious ascendancy. Its opponents do not produce its like.

KAL-099.04

Other extraordinary events are reported of him: birth already circumcised, the seal of prophecy, and perceiving from behind as from in front.

KAL-099.05

Reports also recount his consummate qualities, answered supplications, the falling of idols and of the battlements of Persian palaces, a cloud shading him, the splitting of the moon, a tree being uprooted, stones greeting him and the yearning of the palm trunk.

KAL-099.06

There are also stories of a camel complaining, cooked meat testifying, pebbles praising God, and other signs.

KAL-099.07

Among the proofs adduced are passages of the Torah, Gospel and Psalms, and— [continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 100

KAL-100.01

Among persuasive proofs for fair-minded people are the many perfections combined in him, the comprehensive excellence of his law, and its ascendancy despite few supporters and many enemies.

KAL-100.02

The chief resort of the deniers is to challenge abrogation altogether, a question treated elsewhere. They cite expressions attributed to Mosaic law, including “Keep the Sabbath forever” and “This law is perpetual as long as heaven and earth endure.” [The precise introduction to the citations requires an independent textual witness.]

KAL-100.03

The response is that the disputed expressions either lack their alleged force or refer to a long duration. Texts establish that Muḥammad was sent to all people, that no prophet follows him, that his law is not abrogated, that he is the greatest of prophets and his community a leading community.

KAL-100.04

They differ over who is highest after him: Adam, Abraham, Moses, or Jesus are each named.

KAL-100.05

The Book indicates his night journey to al-Masjid al-Aqṣā. A reported consensus of the second century supports that it happened awake and bodily. Widely transmitted reports indicate the ascent to heaven, while solitary reports extend it to Paradise, the Throne, or the extremity of the world.

KAL-100.06

Section.

KAL-100.07

Among the qualifications of prophecy are being male, sound reason, strong judgment and freedom from characteristics that repel sound natures or impair dignity or the purpose of sending a messenger.

KAL-100.08

The adopted position is that prophets are protected from what would be inconsistent with —[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 101

KAL-101.01

—the evidential import of miracles: lying in transmitting revelation, unbelief, deliberate major sins, and repellent minor sins. The author grounds these exclusions in transmitted proof, while Muʿtazilites appeal to reason. The discussion turns on the scandal of rejecting their testimony, forbidding their example, or judging them deserving punishment.

KAL-101.02

Reports of prophetic faults and repentance are interpreted as involving inadvertence, the abandonment of a better course, or events prior to the prophetic mission.

KAL-101.03

It is preferable not to restrict the number of prophets, even though reports mention 124,000 prophets and 313 messengers, in view of the verse that some messengers are recounted and others not.

KAL-101.04

Most scholars affirm angelic protection from sin, citing verses that they do not act arrogantly, fear their Lord, do as commanded, and tirelessly glorify God.

KAL-101.05

The objector appeals to Iblīs supposedly being among the angels, to what is taken to be their backbiting of Adam, and to their disapproval of his being made vicegerent.

KAL-101.06

The reply is that Iblīs is among the jinn, though included with the angels by predominance of designation; and backbiting consists in seeking to expose another’s deficiency, whereas the angels intended wonder and inquiry about the wisdom of appointing someone apparently less suitable when someone suitable exists.

Cairo 1912 printed page 102

KAL-102.01

As for the report of the punishment of Hārūt and Mārūt, it is a narrated account; the author nevertheless distinguishes it from their practicing sorcery or believing it independently efficacious, describing the matter as teaching with a warning.

KAL-102.02

Most of our school, together with the Shiʿa, hold that prophets are superior to angels; some extend this to the elect of humanity over the elect of angels, and ordinary human beings over ordinary angels.

KAL-102.03

One rational argument is that achieving perfection and persevering in obedience despite distracting temptations makes one more deserving of reward.

KAL-102.04

Scriptural evidence includes “God chose Adam, Noah, the family of Abraham, and the family of ʿImrān above all the worlds.”

KAL-102.05

The angels are among the beings included in that “all worlds”; furthermore, God commanded them to prostrate before Adam in honor and ennoblement, and commanded Adam to teach them the names, intending thereby to make his superiority manifest.

KAL-102.06

Opponents argue that angels already possess intellectual and practical perfections, perform extraordinary acts, know unseen secrets, promptly do good, are free of sin, and are more constant and secure in their knowledge and works.

KAL-102.07

They also cite “I do not tell you that I possess God’s treasuries, or know the unseen, or am an angel,” and “He of mighty powers taught him,” treating angelic knowledge as a superior perfection.

KAL-102.08

And “The Messiah will not disdain to be a servant of God, nor will the angels —” [continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 103

KAL-103.01

—those brought near.” We answer that the first inference is opposed by earlier evidence, while the other verses have interpretations discussed in works of exegesis.

KAL-103.02

The order in which angels are mentioned may reflect temporal priority or the strength of faith in them, rather than superiority of rank.

KAL-103.03

Extraordinary events can also be miracles of saints (*karāmāt*). They differ from prophetic miracles because they are unaccompanied by a claim of prophecy, do not confuse a prophet with someone else, and may magnify the prophet’s standing because his followers reach such states by following him.

KAL-103.04

Saintly wonders differ from sorcery in not proceeding by learned and taught techniques, not admitting an adversarial counter-challenge, and not accompanying an evil soul; [sorcery is associated with] performing specified operations. Both kinds of extraordinary occurrence are represented as actual: the former by the accounts of Mary, Āṣif and the pious, the latter by the evidence that follows.

KAL-103.05

[As to magic,] there is the verse “They teach people magic,” and the report that the Prophet was bewitched, associated here with ʿĀ’isha and Ibn ʿUmar. [The precise relation of the latter two names to the report requires separate hadith-source verification.]

KAL-103.06

The verse “It was made to seem to him through their magic” does not show that all magic is merely imaginary; harm through the evil eye is treated as something attested in experience.

KAL-103.07

The verse “Those who disbelieve nearly cause you to stumble” is cited in this connection; scholars differ regarding healing incantations and amulets.

KAL-103.08

A saint does not reach a prophet’s rank; religious obligations do not fall away from him; sainthood is not higher than prophethood.

KAL-103.09

As for the sainthood of a prophet, some judge it superior because it comprises—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 104

KAL-104.01

—intimacy and special nearness; others rank the prophetic office higher because it mediates between Truth and creation, serves interests in both worlds, and includes the honor of encountering the angel.

KAL-104.02

Section: on resurrection and return.

KAL-104.03

Recreating what has ceased to exist is possible, for intrinsic possibility does not disappear merely with the passage of time; indeed, the initial existence may leave in surviving matter an increased preparedness to exist again.

KAL-104.04

Opponents argue that nothing can be pointed to or predicated of the nonexistent; that restoration would eliminate the difference between the beginning and the return if the very time were restored; and that nonexistence would intervene between a thing and itself.

KAL-104.05

The response is that intelligible reference suffices; the beginning and the restoration differ in their ordered occurrence, first and second, even under the stipulated identity of time, and in that respect a gap of nonexistence is conceivable.

KAL-104.06

Bodily resurrection is established by Qurʾān, tradition, and communal consensus. Explaining bodily resurrection passages merely as metaphors for the soul’s bliss and misery is condemned as distortion.

KAL-104.07

On the view that the soul is immaterial and survives, bodily resurrection is intelligible as its return to original bodily constituents; this is not transmigration.

Cairo 1912 printed page 105

KAL-105.01

—the original, even if the restored body were not numerically the first in every respect, as suggested by “Whenever their skins are roasted, We replace them with other skins.”

KAL-105.02

Deniers object that restoring a nonexistent thing is impossible, but the point has already been addressed, and resurrection does not depend upon the disputed premise as they suppose.

KAL-105.03

They argue that if one person eats another, the consumed bodily parts cannot be restored in the eater without depriving the eaten person of numerical bodily identity, nor restored in the eaten without depriving the eater of it.

KAL-105.04

If an unbeliever consumes a believer, they add, sinful parts would be rewarded or obedient parts punished.

KAL-105.05

The reply is that resurrection concerns the original constituents present from the body’s first formation, which God may preserve from becoming original constituents of another person.

KAL-105.06

As for accompanying bodily accidents, supposing their restoration were required, God can assign the requisite parts to those entitled to them.

KAL-105.07

Of the texts, some establish the return itself, as in “He is the one who originates creation and then restores it,” and “They will say, ‘Who will restore us?’ Say, ‘The One who brought you into being the first time.’”

KAL-105.08

Other verses address doubts over reviving decayed bones, such as “Who will give life to bones when they have crumbled?” and “When we have died and become dust…?”

KAL-105.09

Scholars dispute whether resurrection follows complete annihilation, citing passages on God as First and Last, the passing away of all things, and the restoration of creation as it began.

Cairo 1912 printed page 106

KAL-106.01

—or whether it is reassembly after dispersal, as suggested by the verses on showing how the dead are revived and how the resurrection occurs after death.

KAL-106.02

Paradise and Hell are already created, according to the account of Adam and Eve and the plain meaning of verses such as “prepared,” “brought near,” and “made manifest.”

KAL-106.03

One philosophical objection denies their location in existing celestial spheres or elements because of supposed astronomical impossibilities, insufficient space, or the purported need for a void between separate worlds.

KAL-106.04

Nor, the objector claims, can that other world contain elements possessing natural places: the same element would then have two natural places and would consequently incline both toward and away from [the relevant place].

KAL-106.05

The reply denies these philosophical premises: two worlds might be contained within a wider encompassing reality, have elements of different natures, or possess elements whose positions are not natural in the hypothesized sense.

KAL-106.06

If one argues that “Everything perishes except His face” entails their destruction, it may refer to dependence rather than annihilation; even if an instant of cessation is granted, it need not contradict their commonly understood permanence.

KAL-106.07

Most hold that Paradise is above the seven heavens beneath the Throne, citing “At the Lote Tree of the Boundary, near which is the Garden of Refuge.”

KAL-106.08

Hell is said to lie beneath the earths; the correct position is to suspend judgment on precise location.

Cairo 1912 printed page 107

KAL-107.01

Section.

KAL-107.02

Questioning in the grave, its punishment and its reward are true, established through verses and reports transmitting the meaning abundantly.

KAL-107.03

Among the cited verses are “They are exposed to the Fire morning and evening,” “They were drowned and admitted into Fire,” and “They receive provision, rejoicing in what God has given them.”

KAL-107.04

There are also reports that the grave becomes a garden from the gardens of Paradise or a pit of fire after the dead person is buried.

KAL-107.05

Nor is it far-fetched that the powerful, freely choosing [God] should enlarge the grave sufficiently to permit sitting in it, and that enough of the original bodily parts should remain to sustain life.

KAL-107.06

Nor is it impossible that an observer should fail to perceive what occurs to the dead; the verse concerning only one death is discussed in this connection.

KAL-107.07

The text also cites “You were dead and He gave you life, then He will cause you to die and revive you,” and “Our Lord, You caused us to die twice and gave us life twice.”

KAL-107.08

This does not exclude punishment in the grave: the death that follows the relevant intermediate life need not be counted as a distinct death, or it may be subsumed under the first death.

KAL-107.08A

In sum, what is established by religion is that the deceased possesses a kind of life sufficient to experience pain and pleasure; whether this involves the return of the soul remains uncertain.

KAL-107.09

All the events of Resurrection—including the reckoning and its terrors, the bridge, the balance, and the basin—[continue].

Cairo 1912 printed page 108

KAL-108.01

The detailed conditions of Paradise and Hell are possible things conveyed by the truthful Messenger; assent to them is therefore required.

KAL-108.02

God can make crossing the Bridge easy even if it is sharper than a sword and finer than a hair; deeds may be weighed as written records or given luminous or dark forms.

KAL-108.03

There is no need to explain the Bridge as merely a route to Paradise and Hell or as clear proofs and devotional duties, nor to reduce the Balance to justice or understanding.

KAL-108.04

Section.

KAL-108.05

Reward is God’s favor; punishment is His justice. Their “necessity” refers to God’s promise or threat: He does not break His promise, while the status of threatened punishment is disputed.

KAL-108.06

Deserving them means the appropriateness of attaching them to obedience and disobedience in customary reason and usage; nothing is imposed as a duty upon God.

KAL-108.07

Even abundant acts of worship do not repay all blessings; were reward strictly merited, the switch from lifelong disbelief to faith, or the reverse, would not have its acknowledged effects.

KAL-108.08

The Muʿtazila argue that without obligatory recompense people would neglect obedience and dare disobey; that imposing onerous duties with no corresponding benefit is unjust; and that absence of harm in omitting a task would force obligation for anything beneficial. The reply begins: the mere possibility of omitting an act—[continued on p. 109].

Cairo 1912 printed page 109

KAL-109.01

—does not invalidate the purpose. The mere occurrence [of the act] suffices for what is intended, and the proposed purpose is not confined to the objects they mentioned.

KAL-109.02

Section.

KAL-109.03

There is no dispute that those admitted to Paradise remain there, nor that unbelievers are eternally in Hell; borderline legal categories, such as children of polytheists, are discussed separately.

KAL-109.04

One view assigns those whom God knows would believe to Paradise and those whom He knows would disbelieve to Hell.

KAL-109.05

The Muʿtazila hold that an unrepentant believer who dies with a major sin remains in Hell; our position is that such a person may be pardoned or released after punishment, as indicated by texts describing their exit from Hell and entry into Paradise.

KAL-109.06

Furthermore, reward owed by promise—and on their rational account—cannot be realized except by release from punishment. And if the eternal torment of someone who drank a single mouthful of wine after persevering in obedience would not be injustice, nothing would be injustice.

KAL-109.07

If opponents invoke general scriptural threats of eternal punishment, we restrict them to unbelievers or to sins treated as lawful, or take some language of remaining as signifying long duration, thereby reconciling the proofs.

KAL-109.08

They argue that a wrongdoer’s eventual departure would imply an unbeliever’s departure because both are finite agents; we deny the proposed ground of analogy, particularly against explicit texts and in doctrines of belief.

Cairo 1912 printed page 110

KAL-110.01

Some hold that a single major sin nullifies all acts of obedience; others say good and evil acts counterbalance, whichever is greater canceling the corresponding share of the other. Both positions are challenged from text and reason.

KAL-110.02

There are further differences between simply canceling the smaller amount and subtracting an equivalent amount from the greater total.

KAL-110.03

They support their thesis with such verses as “Their deeds are nullified,” “Do not nullify your charities,” and “lest your deeds be nullified.”

KAL-110.04

These texts do not prove the disputed claim that one full good deed is abolished through an earlier or later sin.

KAL-110.05

This is countered by verses such as “Whoever does an atom’s weight of good shall see it,” and by the argument that no major sin has a burden exceeding the reward due to knowing God; on the proposed balancing account, knowledge of God would then have to avert every major sin. [The print’s verb in this reductio is retained for second-witness checking.]

KAL-110.06

Section.

KAL-110.07

Forgiveness of major sins without repentance is possible, because punishment is God’s right, which He may waive.

KAL-110.08

Scriptural proofs include “He pardons misdeeds,” “He pardons much,” and “God forgives all sins”; associating partners with Him is singled out in “God does not forgive that partners be associated with Him.”

KAL-110.09

Reports support this reading; restricting the passages to minor sins, postrepentance forgiveness, or postponement of punishment is contrary to their apparent sense.

Cairo 1912 printed page 111

KAL-111.01

Clear reports undermine some restrictive interpretations. The Muʿtazila object that threats against grave sinners must be carried out, for failure to do so would amount to falsehood or encouragement to sin.

KAL-111.02

The answer is that the same major sinners are included in general promises; this would clash with the unanimously denied breaking of the promise. Besides, the bare possibility of punishment is a deterrent—how much more when punishment is preponderantly expected.

KAL-111.03

If forgiveness of major sins is possible without repentance, it is all the more so with intercession. God commands, “Seek forgiveness for your sin and for believing men and women.”

KAL-111.04

The Prophet is cited as saying: “I have reserved my intercession for the grave sinners of my community.” Thus texts such as “No intercession will be accepted from it”—[continue into the following clause].

KAL-111.05

—and “Nor will the intercession of the intercessors benefit them,” even granting their generality across times and circumstances, are specified to unbelievers so that the evidences may be reconciled.

KAL-111.06

The revealed law plainly affirms intercession; the Muʿtazila interpret it as seeking additional benefits. But then whoever asks God to augment the Prophet’s honor would, on their definition, count as an intercessor *for the Prophet*.

KAL-111.07

Restricting it to minor sins or people who have already repented is manifestly inadequate.

KAL-111.08

A major sin is either one evincing disregard for religion, or one specifically threatened with punishment. Others define gravity comparatively: an offense is major relative to a lesser one and minor relative to a greater one.

KAL-111.09

Others enumerate idolatry, murder, false accusation of sexual misconduct (*qadhf*), fornication, and flight—[continued on p.112].

Cairo 1912 printed page 112

KAL-112.01

—from battle, sorcery, consuming an orphan’s property, disobedience to parents, violating the sanctuary; some also add usury, theft and drinking wine.

KAL-112.02

Section.

KAL-112.03

In the law, repentance is regret over sin *because it is sin*; some add resolve not to repeat it.

KAL-112.04

Muʿtazilites describe it as recognizing the wrong and wishing, were it possible, to undo it. Repentance is obligatory by revelation: “Repent to God.”

KAL-112.05

They also argue for rational obligation because repentance averts harm, and affirm its acceptance and immediacy.

KAL-112.06

For us, remission of punishment proceeds solely from divine generosity; many opponents tie it to repentance itself. Repeating repentance every time a sin is remembered is not necessarily required, and repentance from some sins in particular is valid.

KAL-112.07

General repentance may suffice even with awareness of individual offenses, although its completion can require further duties, such as returning stolen property or making restitution.

KAL-112.08

Other obligations can remain alongside repentance, including prescribed penalties, making up missed prayers, correcting those misled and apologizing to people wronged.

KAL-112.09

Commanding obligatory conduct and forbidding prohibited conduct are duties; encouraging recommended conduct and discouraging disliked conduct are recommended, subject to knowledge of the act, possible benefit and avoidance of greater harm.

KAL-112.10

This is not restricted—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 113

KAL-113.01

—to a ruler, except actions leading to fighting, nor to a jurist except where specialist judgment is required. It is a communal obligation discharged when enough people perform it.

KAL-113.02

“Take care of yourselves” does not establish that the duty is absent; nor does “There is no compulsion in religion,” which Taftāzānī here treats as abrogated, refute it.

KAL-113.03

Section.

KAL-113.04

In ordinary language *īmān* is assent; legally it is assent to what is necessarily known to have been brought by the Prophet.

KAL-113.05

Most add a verbal confession, and many early authorities include assent, confession, and works together.

KAL-113.06

Abandoning works does not in itself extinguish faith, contrary to the Muʿtazilites, nor render one an unbeliever, contrary to the Khārijites.

KAL-113.07

If it is asked how the whole could survive the loss of a part, we reply that “faith” may name the foundation of salvation or its complete and fully saving realization.

KAL-113.08

The evidence that faith belongs to the heart includes “He inscribed faith in their hearts”; “his heart is secure in faith”; “their hearts have not believed”; and “faith has not yet entered your hearts.”

KAL-113.09

Prophetic reports speak of the heart’s remaining firm in religion and of a mustard-seed’s weight of faith in the heart.

KAL-113.10

The two testimonies suffice for worldly legal protection of life and property; faith itself is assenting, submitting, and accepting—expressed by a Persian term meaning acceptance or believing.

Cairo 1912 printed page 114

KAL-114.01

Its opposite is rejection and denial, not merely a lack of knowledge: some unbelievers recognized the truth as they recognized their sons and were inwardly certain of it while denying it.

KAL-114.02

By contrast, the opposites of mere cognition would be ignorance or unfamiliarity. When earlier authorities use “knowledge” or “recognition” for faith, the intended knowledge is assent, not bare awareness.

KAL-114.03

The ordinary sense of assent was not replaced by an entirely new technical sense, which explains immediate compliance without asking for a wholly new definition; the law specifies the objects of assent.

KAL-114.04

Thus, to the request “Tell me about faith,” the response correctly enumerates believing in God, His angels, His books and His messengers.

KAL-114.05

An objection: faith is commanded, so it must be a voluntary act, whereas assent—contrasted with denial—is a quality belonging to knowledge.

KAL-114.06

We answer that a commanded object need not belong to the Aristotelian category of action; it must be something to which power and voluntary acquisition can relate, even if it is intrinsically a quality, like knowledge or examination.

KAL-114.07

Examples are standing, sitting, becoming warm or cool, praying, and fasting. The point is that assent is required to arise through volition and the undertaking of its means.

KAL-114.08

It does not follow that faith is a different kind of cognition from the assent opposed to conception in logic, or from the indicated notion of acceptance. The argument then turns to a certainty devoid of—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 115

KAL-115.01

Submission or assent, like that of a sophist or certain unbelievers, is not always [properly called] assent in the relevant sense; it may be conception or some intermediate state.

KAL-115.02

Certainty accompanied by assent, if it is devoid of acquisition and choice, does not count as faith in the legal sense.

KAL-115.03

On that account, the assent of angels to what reached them, of prophets to what was revealed to them, and of the truly faithful to what they heard from the Prophet or found in their hearts on witnessing a miracle must all be considered voluntarily acquired.

KAL-115.04

Or it must have occurred after they were able to obtain it by choice.

KAL-115.05

One may dispute whether certainty can exist without assent, and whether some unbelievers can be certain of everything the Prophet brought while still failing to assent.

KAL-115.06

Their unbelief may instead be traced to their refusal to assent, inferred from signs of denial such as rejecting commands and rulings—although a person might assent and yet prostrate to an idol.

KAL-115.07

Faith, as established, is a name for assent without semantic transfer; one who believes can also receive commands and prohibitions, as in “O you who believe, do not put yourselves forward.”

KAL-115.08

Works may be coordinated with faith in expressions such as “those who believed and did righteous deeds”; and believers can be censured for wrongdoing, as in the verse concerning two parties of believers who fight.

KAL-115.09

Faith is a prerequisite for worship, and one who assents and confesses is counted a believer before the appearance of works—[the argument continues].

Cairo 1912 printed page 116

KAL-116.01

—even though works are not included in the essential definition of faith. Thus, when many of the early authorities spoke of faith as assent, confession and works, they meant complete faith.

KAL-116.02

Similarly, it is said that outward confession is an additional pillar whose absence does not itself extinguish inward faith.

KAL-116.03

The Muʿtazilites reject applying “faith” to bare assent concerning the specified objects and instead claim that the term has been transferred to include works.

KAL-116.04

They appeal to “That is the upright religion” and “The religion with God is Islam”; the relation between Islam and faith will be addressed shortly.

KAL-116.05

Other citations include “Believers are only those whose hearts tremble when God is mentioned” and “God would not let your faith go to waste.”

KAL-116.06

The reply is that these may refer to sincerity and religious observance; the “religion” in question may be the religion of Islam, while Islam and faith might have distinct senses.

KAL-116.07

“Believers” may mean believers possessing complete faith; “faith” may designate prayer figuratively or assent to the obligation of prayer.

KAL-116.08

As for such reports as “The fornicator does not fornicate while he is a believer,” the apparent sense must be interpreted in context, as also the verse “Most of them do not believe in God without associating others with Him.”

KAL-116.09

The verse “Among people are those who say: We believe in God” may address verbal profession alone rather than genuine inner assent.

KAL-116.10

Acts such as prostrating to an idol or casting the Qurʾān into filth constitute unbelief not merely by falling short in works while keeping faith intact—[continued on p117].

Cairo 1912 printed page 117

KAL-117.01

Rather, the Law has made certain transgressions signs of denial.

KAL-117.02

According to us, the perpetrator of a major sin is a believer; according to the Muʿtazilites, neither believer nor unbeliever. They reason that such a person retains some legal effects of belief, such as protection of life and property, but lacks certain qualifications such as holding the imamate, judgeship or giving testimony.

KAL-117.03

They therefore assigned the grave sinner a position between the two positions, and a name between the two names. They claimed this adopts what is agreed upon—iniquity (fisq)—and avoids what is disputed, namely faith and unbelief.

KAL-117.04

The response is that the view abandons another agreed matter: the absence of an intermediate category.

KAL-117.05

According to the Khārijites, the grave sinner is an unbeliever, relying upon apparently literal statements describing sinners as unbelievers, although these may be expressions of severe warning.

KAL-117.06

The Bāṭiniyya are also mentioned in connection with interpreting punishment as restricted to unbelievers, and similar interpretations.

KAL-117.07

Another view calls the sinner a hypocrite, arguing that disobedience betrays the falsity of his professed assent. This inference is denied; traditions treating lying and similar conduct as signs of hypocrisy require interpretation.

KAL-117.08

Section: There is consensus that every believer is a Muslim and conversely, and that their legal ruling is one, because both refer to acceptance and submission. Yet because their concepts differ, they can be conjoined as distinct expressions.

KAL-117.09

Thus revelation juxtaposes “Muslim men and Muslim women, believing men and believing women”; it can likewise associate assent with submission.

KAL-117.10

And since “Islam” can be applied to outward surrender and compliance, it may be affirmed in a case where faith is denied, as in the following scriptural statement— [continued on p. 118].

Cairo 1912 printed page 118

KAL-118.01

“The Bedouins said, ‘We believe.’ Say: You have not believed; rather say: We have submitted.” The discussions of faith’s object and Islam’s practices must be distinguished.

KAL-118.02

In the well-known report, faith is described as believing in God and the other articles; Islam as testifying that there is no god but God, and so forth.

KAL-118.03

The majority hold that faith neither increases nor decreases insofar as it is assent attaining certainty; it varies if the name is extended to obedient deeds.

KAL-118.04

The objection is that certainty itself varies in strength, and the faith of ordinary members of the community is certainly not equal to that of the prophets.

KAL-118.05

Moreover, the apparent import of Scripture and reports supports increase and decrease: “When His signs are recited to them, they increase them in faith.”

KAL-118.06

Other cited expressions include “that they may increase in faith along with their faith” and “that those who believe may increase in faith.”

KAL-118.07

A report is cited describing faith increasing until its possessor enters Paradise and decreasing until its possessor enters the Fire.

KAL-118.08

Explaining the increase solely through persistence, stability, predisposition, added detail of what is believed, or an increase of its effects and illuminations is strained.

KAL-118.09

Many Companions and jurists allow the reservation “I am a believer, God willing,” as reverence, invocation of blessing, or uncertainty about the faith by which a life ends and salvation is attained. The faith presently possessed may still be real, as may the present state of unbelief and the categories of felicity and wretchedness.

KAL-118.10

Others take the contrary position—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 119

KAL-119.01

They disallow the reservation because it suggests doubt about one’s actual present faith.

KAL-119.02

Section: the majority accept the faith of one who follows authority without demonstrative proof: the definition applies, and there is no evidence making demonstration an essential condition. The analogy to faith at the point of despair is defective, since that situation has distinct conditions.

KAL-119.03

Those who disallow such faith include Muʿtazilites requiring the capacity, in each question, to establish an argument and resolve an objection.

KAL-119.04

Another theologian requires only possession of an argument in general; later Muʿtazilites are said to have returned toward this view.

KAL-119.05

They specify that the dispute concerns a person raised on a remote mountaintop who has never reflected, but is told what must be believed and assents.

KAL-119.06

By contrast, one raised in Islamic territory, even in a desert, and acquainted through widespread reports with the Prophet’s condition has grounds for rational consideration.

KAL-119.07

Some say that inquiry is obligatory only for some, while those incapable of reasoning, such as the unlearned, need only follow the truth or hear the rudiments of proofs.

KAL-119.08

The dispute is not over applying the outward rulings of Islam but over whether such a person receives the punishment of unbelief. Unbelief is discussed as absence of faith where faith ought to be present, even without explicit denial or rejection.

KAL-119.09

Those who define it in terms of denial of God treat ignorance of what is requisite as relevant to the rulings; the detailed wording needs rechecking.

KAL-119.10

And declaring unbelief because of certain—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 120

KAL-120.01

—acts, notwithstanding the persistence of complete assent, if admitted, is based upon the Lawgiver’s treating certain forbidden acts as signs of denial, as likewise certain doctrinal interpretations concerning first principles.

KAL-120.02

An unbeliever who displays faith is specifically called a hypocrite; one who previously professed Islam, an apostate; one whose belief entails multiple gods, an associationist.

KAL-120.03

One adhering to certain revealed books is a scripturalist (*kitābī*); one attributing events ultimately to time is called a *dahrī*.

KAL-120.04

One denying the Maker is a denialist (*muʿaṭṭil*); one outwardly exhibiting Islam while inwardly harboring doctrines of unbelief is a *zindīq*.

KAL-120.05

The majority hold that one of the people of the qibla who differs from the truth is not an unbeliever unless he denies something necessarily established in religion.

KAL-120.06

For the Prophet and those after him did not interrogate people’s private doctrines; determining the fundamental teachings concerns their explanation and the manifestness of their evidences.

KAL-120.07

Muʿtazilites declare unbelief on account of many doctrines specific to the Sunnis, which occasioned the statement “We declare unbelievers those who declare us unbelievers.”

KAL-120.08

Iniquity (*fisq*) is departing from obedience to God through committing a major sin or persisting in a minor one. Doctrinal innovation (*bidʿa*) is opposition to the people of truth in belief; its prescribed treatment, in the author’s formulation, is aversion and humiliation.

KAL-120.09

Some extend innovation to certain subsidiary questions; others include everything that did not occur in the Companions’ age—[continued].

Cairo 1912 printed page 121

KAL-121.01

—during the Companions’ time; on this broader classification, some innovations may be good.

KAL-121.02

Section: the imamate is a general headship over religious and worldly affairs in succession to the Prophet.

KAL-121.03

Appointing an imam is obligatory upon the community by revealed authority according to us, on the grounds of consensus and because it is a necessary means for duties such as enforcing legal penalties and securing innumerable benefits.

KAL-121.04

Some Muʿtazilites make its obligation rational, because the imamate prevents harm.

KAL-121.05

The reply is that the benefit alone does not entail blame and punishment for leaving it undone; the Shiʿites instead maintain that God is obliged to provide an imam as grace facilitating knowledge and obedience.

KAL-121.06

The response denies that anything is obligatory upon God, observes possible harms, and argues that if the fullest grace required the imam’s manifest presence, such manifestation would have occurred.

KAL-121.07

The Khārijite claim that no imam is obligatory, because the office causes discord, is rejected on the ground of the argument for it and the more serious discord arising from its absence.

KAL-121.08

Conditions include legal capacity, free status, being male, and uprightness. The majority add courage, independent legal competence, and sound judgment, because their need is evident.

KAL-121.09

He must belong to Quraysh, on the basis of the report “The imams are from Quraysh” and precedents involving Qurashī candidates.

KAL-121.10

The Khārijites and many Muʿtazilites dissent, citing the report to obey even if a mutilated Abyssinian slave is appointed over you.

Cairo 1912 printed page 122

KAL-122.01

In an emergency, the office may pass to a person possessing sufficient coercive strength, whether through appointment or taking control.

KAL-122.02

Shiʿites stipulate Hashimite—and indeed ʿAlid—descent and superiority over contemporaries; the question whether one less excellent may be advanced is disputed.

KAL-122.03

It is answered that a less excellent person may be more suitable, while analogy with prophecy is invoked to argue for impeccability.

KAL-122.04

Arguments for the imam’s impeccability are drawn from the duty of obedience, the exclusion of wrongdoers from the covenant, the alleged regress if a sinful imam required another imam over him, and the danger of subverting the law which he is to guard.

KAL-122.05

The objections deny the relevant analogy; obedience holds only where commands do not contravene the Law; disputed cases revert to proofs and judgment; and non-impeccability does not itself imply actual wrongdoing.

KAL-122.06

The duty to obey is legally rather than rationally established, and the imam does not guard the law simply through his own essence.

KAL-122.07

The majority hold that the imamate is constituted through selection by those qualified to bind and loosen; the conduct of the Companions after the Prophet’s death is cited, as are later precedents of allegiance and selection.

KAL-122.08

Shiʿites object that electorates may not know an imam’s necessary qualities—impeccability, superior excellence, complete knowledge of religion—and deny that the office may be conferred by ordinary human appointment.

KAL-122.09

The chosen incumbent, they argue, would be the people’s deputy, rather than God’s or the Messenger’s.

Cairo 1912 printed page 123

KAL-123.01

These conditions are rejected; the alleged unknowability is disputed, and the possibility of appointing other authorities does not entail denial of the community’s role in selecting an imam.

KAL-123.02

Consider also the assessment of relative advantages. Even if the objection is granted, the strife ensuing from the absence of an imam would be worse; the one selected is the successor to God and His Messenger by the authorization of the Law.

KAL-123.03

The response invokes the completion of religion and the Prophet’s practice of appointing deputies and making testamentary instructions; thus the verse “Today I have perfected your religion” is not conclusive against this account, for he did indeed appoint deputies and give instructions.

KAL-123.04

As for the alleged explicit designation of ʿAlī, the author objects that it would impugn the senior Companions as ignorant or obstinate, and would raise a difficulty concerning ʿAlī’s own failure to assert the alleged designation as decisive proof.

KAL-123.05

It would also, he argues, conflict with scriptural praise of the Companions as the best community.

KAL-123.06

The author cites reports that ʿAlī accepted deliberation and said to Ṭalḥa, “If you wish, I shall pledge allegiance to you”; that he assisted Abū Bakr and ʿUmar, counseled reconciliation, and joined them in Friday and festival prayers.

KAL-123.07

He further cites that many leading members of the Prophet’s Household denied any explicit designation, and that al-ʿAbbās told ʿAlī, “Extend your hand, that I may pledge allegiance to you.”

KAL-123.08

Section: The imam after the Messenger of God was Abū Bakr, the author argues, on the basis of agreement among the people of binding and loosening; he adduces reports of ʿAlī’s acquiescence, his calling Abū Bakr “caliph,” and his praising him both during his lifetime and after his death.

KAL-123.09

The author also cites the explanation of ʿAlī’s delayed allegiance. He then argues that the agreed candidates were Abū Bakr, ʿAlī and al-ʿAbbās, and that agreement subsequently converged—[continuing on p. 124]—upon Abū Bakr.

Cairo 1912 printed page 124

KAL-124.01

—upon him, and so his appointment was determined. A further argument may be drawn from the verse: “You will be called to [fight] a people of great might.”

KAL-124.02

The summoner is identified as Abū Bakr or ʿUmar, and the reports “Follow those after me, Abū Bakr and ʿUmar” and “The caliphate after me will last thirty years” are cited.

KAL-124.03

The Prophet appointed him to lead prayer and did not remove him; a statement attributed to ʿAlī infers that one advanced in religion may be advanced in worldly leadership.

KAL-124.04

Shiʿites object that Abū Bakr lacked impeccability, supreme excellence, or explicit designation, adducing verses including “Your guardian is only God and His Messenger…”

KAL-124.05

The debated word *walī* is read either as holder of governing authority or as guardian in mutual aid, which may encompass the whole community.

KAL-124.06

The reply takes the verse to concern affection and mutual support rather than political appointment. The believers’ description can be praise or an added honour; “while they bow” can alternatively be read as coordinated wording about believers bowing in prayer (unlike the Jewish prayer invoked in this argument), or as describing them as humble. Hence neither the plural subject nor the restrictive wording necessarily singles out ʿAlī. [The elliptical wording of the Cairo print at this point still requires direct witness collation.]

KAL-124.07

At that time the imamate was not of that kind; applying a plural expression to just one person is strained, and ʿAlī had no operative governmental authority then. Reading it instead as future authority does not work for God and His Messenger.

KAL-124.08

The reported statements “For whomever I am *mawlā*, ʿAlī is his *mawlā*,” and “You are to me as Aaron was to Moses, except that no prophet follows me,” are discussed.

KAL-124.09

The argument turns on whether *walī/mawlā* denotes authority over affairs; the refutation continues on the next page.

Cairo 1912 printed page 125

KAL-125.01

The objectors argue that other readings would be pointless and that Aaron’s rank was broadly inclusive, so succession is established.

KAL-125.02

The response denies the alleged evidentiary weight and argues that isolated reports cannot overturn consensus; even if accepted, they do not establish exclusive appointment, particularly since they were not cited decisively when needed.

KAL-125.03

Further expressions cited by the opposing side include greeting ʿAlī as Commander of the Faithful, “You are the successor after me,” “He is the imam of the godfearing,” and “This is my caliph over you.”

KAL-125.04

Further alleged designation reports include “You are my brother, testamentary executor, successor after me, and one who settles my debt.”

KAL-125.05

Some argue that the first three caliphs were unfit on grounds of alleged wrongdoing or defects; the subsequent objections must be assessed separately.

KAL-125.06

The reply is that some allegations are fabrications, others irrelevant to legitimacy, and others admit alternative interpretations.

KAL-125.07

ʿUmar then held the imamate through Abū Bakr’s appointment and communal agreement, and ʿUthmān through the six-member consultation instituted by ʿUmar.

KAL-125.07A

Then came ʿAlī, by the agreement of those qualified to bind and loosen to pledge allegiance to him.

KAL-125.08

The narrative proceeds to al-Ḥasan, who relinquished authority to Muʿāwiya after six months to quiet the discord; the polity moved toward kingship and sultanate.

KAL-125.09

Excellence is ranked in the order of the caliphs: generally, the agreement of many scholars is held to indicate substantial evidence for this ordering.

Cairo 1912 printed page 126

KAL-126.01

As for particular proofs, he cites “The most godfearing, who gives his wealth to purify himself, will be kept away from it,” and applies the verse to Abū Bakr.

KAL-126.02

He cites a report: “After the prophets and messengers, the sun has neither risen nor set upon anyone better than Abū Bakr.”

KAL-126.03

He further cites “The best of my community is Abū Bakr, then ʿUmar,” and “Were there a prophet after me, it would be ʿUmar.”

KAL-126.04

He adduces reports of ʿUthmān’s brotherhood and companionship in Paradise, together with the widely transmitted reports of the Companions’ deeds, circumstances, and efforts in the service of Islam.

KAL-126.05

Shiʿites assert the superiority of ʿAlī and cite verses concerning love of the Prophet’s kin and the assistance of Gabriel and righteous believers.

KAL-126.06

Further traditions are brought forward—including a saying beginning “Whoever wishes to look upon Adam…,” the bird report, and the claim that ʿAlī was more ascetic and more learned—to argue for his distinction.

KAL-126.07

The response distinguishes the question of who is greatest before God, conceding the special honors attributed to Fāṭima and to al-Ḥasan and al-Ḥusayn.

KAL-126.08

The ten named Companions—including the four caliphs, Ṭalḥa, al-Zubayr, ʿAbd al-Raḥmān, Saʿd, Saʿīd and Abū ʿUbayda—are said to have received good tidings of Paradise.

KAL-126.09

Excellence rests in knowledge and godfearing conduct; the sound position is to honor all Companions and refrain from denigrating their conflicts, particularly the Emigrants and Helpers, owing to scriptural praise of them.

KAL-126.10

Reports cited include “Fear God concerning my Companions,” “Do not revile my Companions,” and “The best generations are my generation…”

KAL-126.11

Discussion of ʿAlī’s refraining—[continued on the final page].

Cairo 1912 printed page 127

KAL-127.01

His delay in pledging allegiance to Abū Bakr is explained by perplexity or grief; questions concerning the defense of ʿUthmān, the acceptance of his own allegiance, and the pursuit of the killers are explained through concerns about the event, power, and liability for acts committed in rebellion.

KAL-127.02

Some refrained from joining him in the wars because of their own independent judgment or because he had not required them to join—not because they disputed his imamate. In the Battle of the Camel, the Battle of Ṣiffīn, and the war against the Khārijites, ʿAlī was in the right.

KAL-127.03

Those who opposed him were rebels, not unbelievers or morally corrupt persons, because they possessed an interpretive uncertainty; this is why ʿAlī forbade cursing the people of Syria.

KAL-127.04

Conclusion: sound reports describe the coming of an imam descended from Fāṭima, the descent of Jesus, the emergence of the Antichrist and other signs of the Hour.

KAL-127.05

These include the Beast of the Earth, Gog and Magog, the rising of the sun in the west, the three sinkings of the earth, the dwindling of knowledge and trustworthiness, the prevalence of disobedience and betrayal, and the leadership of the wicked and base.

KAL-127.06

These events appear to occur near the Hour; this does not contradict the excellence of the latter part of the community, in accordance with the Prophet’s saying: “My community is like rain: one cannot tell whether its beginning or its end is better.”

KAL-127.07

May God grant us the good of the Hereafter and of this world, and grant us success in knowing what He loves and approves. He is the best giver of success and helper. Praise belongs to God, Lord of all worlds.

Gnamma Research · Working edition; not a multi-witness critical text. Printed pages and editorial divisions are distinguished.